MESSAGE

OF THE

PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES,

COMMUNICATING,

In compliance with a resolution of the Senate of the 5th of February last, correspondence upon the subject of the murder, by the inhabitants of the island of Formosa, of the ship's company of the American bark Rover.

APRIL 23, 1868.—Read, referred to the Committee on Foreign Relations, and ordered to be printed.

To the Senate of the United States:

In answer to the resolution of the Senate of the 5th of February last, calling for the correspondence upon the subject of the murder, by the inhabitants of the island of Formosa, of the ship's company of the American bark Rover, I transmit a report from the Secretary of State and a report from the Secretary of the Navy, with accompanying papers.

ANDREW JOHNSON.

WASHINGTON, *April* 13, 1868.

DEPARTMENT OF STATE,
Washington, April 13, 1868.

The Secretary of State, to whom was referred the resolution of the Senate of the 5th of February last, requesting the President to communicate to that body, "if compatible with the public interest, a copy of any official correspondence upon the subject of the murder, by the inhabitants of Formosa, of the ship's company of the American bark Rover, wrecked upon the coast of that island, and also relative to any measures which may have been adopted for the purpose of obtaining redress for the outrage," has the honor to lay before the President the papers specified in the subjoined list.

Respectfully submitted.

WILLIAM H. SEWARD.

The PRESIDENT.

List of accompanying papers.

No. 1.—Mr. Burlingame to Mr. Seward, April 23, 1867.
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No. 15.—Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward, May 11, 1867, with an accompaniment.
No. 16.—Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward, May 11, 1867.
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No. 18.—Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward, June 30, 1867.
No. 19.—Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward, July 5, 1867.
No. 20.—Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward, July 30, 1867, with accompaniments
No. 21.—Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward, September 4, 1867, with accompaniments.
No. 22.—Mr. F. W. Seward to Mr. LeGendre, September 13, 1867.
No. 23.—Mr. F. W. Seward to Mr. LeGendre, September 24, 1867.
No. 24.—Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward, November 21, 1867, with accompaniments.

No. 1.

Mr. Burlingame to Mr. Seward.

No. 137.] LEGATION OF THE UNITED STATES,
Peking, April 23, 1867.

SIR: I yesterday received, through the British minister, Sir Rutherford Alcock, a despatch from Charles Carroll, British consul at Taiwan, Formosa, covering a report of Captain G. D. Broad, of her Majesty's naval service, from which I learn the principal details of the loss of the American bark Rover, and the whole of her crew of eleven persons, who were murdered by the savages on the south coast of Formosa.

The Rover, Captain Hand, left Swatow for Neuchwang, on the 9th of March, and on the 12th struck on a rock south of Formosa, (the Vele Rete rocks,) and being in a sinking condition was abandoned by the captain and crew, who left in two boats, one of which alone has been heard from. The news was brought by a Chinese sailor, who escaped in the captain's boat, and who, after incredible hardships, communicated with Captain Broad and the British authorities at Takow. He says all but himself were killed immediately after landing by a musketry fire from the woods. Captain Broad, upon learning this news, immediately tried to save the lives of those who might be living by sending offers of ransom. He subsequently, accompanied by the British consul, Mr. Carroll, with the Cormorant, steamed to the place pointed out by the Chinaman, where the murder was committed, and where the Rover's boat was found. While landing, Captain Broad and party were fired upon, and with difficulty escaped under cover of a fire from the Cormorant. After shelling the woods Captain Broad returned to Takow.

I give these brief details only, as you have doubtless heard all the particulars long before this will reach you from our consuls at the south. I had previously heard a rumor of this affair from our consul at Amoy, Mr. LeGendre, who informed me that he was about to visit the place with the war vessel Ashuelot. I immediately called the attention of the Chinese government to the above facts, and received from it every possible expression of regret for the murders, and

proffers of aid to punish the guilty parties. I wrote at once to Admiral Bell, requesting him to co-operate with the Chinese authorities in such manner as the case might require. I wrote also to our consul, Mr. LeGendre, in the same sense, requesting him to thank at once the British consul, Mr. Charles Carroll, and Captain Broad, in the name of our government, and to say to them that I would thank them officially through the British minister here, and at the same time would call the attention of our government to their noble conduct.

These savages are not Chinese, but outlaws of another race, who from time immemorial have been a sort of wrecking banditti. The Chinese and the British minister unite with me in a general movement against them.

I will advise you as I learn of the progress made.

I have the honor to be, sir, your obedient servant,

ANSON BURLINGAME.

Hon. WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State, &c., &c., &c.

No. 2.

Mr. Burlingame to Mr. Seward.

No. 142.] UNITED STATES LEGATION,
Peking, June 19, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor to forward herewith despatches Nos. 19, 20, 21, of Charles W. LeGendre, esq., our consul at Amoy, in relation to the American bark Rover, together with a letter of thanks from myself in the name of my government, (A,) to Charles Carroll, esq., her Majesty's consul at Taiwan, Commander G. D. Broad, of her Majesty's ship Cormorant, with the officers and crew under him, for their prompt and courageous efforts to rescue and avenge the captain and crew of the American bark Rover.

I have the honor to be, sir, your obedient servant,

ANSON BURLINGAME.

Hon. WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State.

A.

Mr. Burlingame to Mr. Brown.

UNITED STATES LEGATION,
Peking, June 18, 1867.

SIR: It gives me great pleasure to thank through you, in the name of my government, Charles Carroll, esq., her Majesty's consul at Taiwan, Commander G. D. Broad, of her Majesty's ship Cormorant, with the officers and crew of the same, for their prompt and courageous efforts to rescue and avenge the captain and crew of the United States bark Rover.

The manner of their conduct was as admirable as the motive which prompted it. "We both fully agreed that, though the vessel was American, it was our duty to render the same assistance to the crew as we should had it been a British ship." This noble language of Mr. Carroll, alluding to himself and Commander Broad, states the policy which should guide two kindred nations. It is the fruit of that co-operative system in the east approved by our respective governments. It recalls the best *souvenirs* of our history, and will awaken a new sense of obligation in the breasts of my countrymen.

I have already had the pleasure of calling the attention of my government to the conduct of Consul Carroll and Commander Broad. The names of the officers and crew of the Cormorant have also been brought to its notice.

May I now request you to acquaint her Majesty's government with this inadequate expression of thanks, to the end that it may appreciate, as others do, the humanity and valor of these officers and sailors.

I have the honor to be, sir, your obedient servant,

ANSON BURLINGAME.

J. M. LEAVY BROWN,
Her Majesty's Chargé d'Affaires, Peking.

No. 3.

Mr. Seward to Mr. Burlingame.

No. 202.] DEPARTMENT OF STATE,
Washington, June 20, 1867.

The department is informed by a despatch* of the 7th of April last, received from the United States consul at Hong Kong, of the wreck off the southern point of the island of Formosa of the American ship Rover, on the 12th of March, 1867, while proceeding from Swatow to Neuchwang. The circumstances connected with the loss of this vessel, as narrated in the despatch, leave no doubt that the crew, together with the wife of the master, were cruelly murdered by the savages inhabiting that portion of the island. You are accordingly instructed—

First. To inquire into the facts of the case.

Second. To report whether the Chinese government is established or acknowledged in any, or in what degree, in the region where the atrocious transaction occurred. If clearly so, then to demand investigation and punishment, with such indemnities as are possible.

Third. If no organized government exists there you will suggest what form of proceeding should be adopted with a view to obtain redress and prevent such transactions in future.

Fourth. You are advised that in no case do the United States desire to seize and hold possession of Formosa or any part of said island.

I am, sir, your obedient servant,

WILLIAM H. SEWARD.

ANSON BURLINGAME, Esq., *&c., &c., &c.*

No. 4.

Mr. Seward to Mr. Burlingame.

No. 206.] DEPARTMENT OF STATE,
Washington, July 15, 1867.

SIR: The department has received a despatch† of the 1st of April last from Mr. LeGendre, the United States consul at Amoy, accompanied by an extract from a letter of a Mr. McPhail, of Formosa, on the subject of the wreck of the American bark Rover, on a shoal near that island, and the subsequent murder by the savages of thirteen out of fourteen of her crew. Mr. LeGendre says that

* For this enclosure see No. 13. † For this enclosure see No 12.

he was about to embark in the United States steamer Ashuelot for the scene of the disaster, for the purpose of inquiring into the case; that he has written to you, and had asked instructions in regard to it. The directions to you upon the subject, contained in my No. 202 of the 20th of last month, are repeated.

I am, sir, your obedient servant,

WILLIAM H. SEWARD.

ANSON BURLINGAME, Esq., *&c., &c., &c., Peking.*

No. 5.

Mr. Hunter to Mr. Burlingame.

No. 210.] DEPARTMENT OF STATE,
Washington, July 24, 1867.

SIR: I have to acknowledge the receipt of your despatch of the 23d of April last, No. 137, concerning the shipwreck of the American bark Rover. Substantially the same account had been received through the Navy Department a short time previously to the reception of your despatch. The instructions already sent to you on this subject will, it is believed, prove a sufficient guide for your treatment of this matter.

I am, sir, your obedient servant,

W. HUNTER.

ANSON BURLINGAME, Esq , *&c., &c., &c.*

No. 6.

Mr. Seward to Mr. Burlingame.

No. 213.] DEPARTMENT OF STATE,
Washington, August 23, 1867.

SIR: You are already acquainted with the tragic affair of the loss of the United States merchant vessel Rover, off the island of Formosa, and the destruction of her crew by the savages residing there.

From a report made upon that subject to the Secretary of the Navy, by Rear Admiral Bell, I extract as follows:

I am satisfied that the barbarities of those savages cannot be permanently stopped until the government of Peking be induced, by the action of the American and other foreign ministers at that court, to occupy all the villages and bays on the east coast and on the south, and thus drive the aboriginals back to the interior of the island. They are a cruel pest to all mariners who may be so unfortunate as to be thrown on their coast; and there is no known way of dealing with them as a community.

The President desires that you will confer with the representatives of the western powers at Peking, and in co-operation with them, if it shall be practicable, earnestly urge upon the Emperor's government the policy suggested by Rear Admiral Bell. I shall look with much interest for your proceedings under this instruction.

I am, sir, your obedient servant,

WILLIAM H. SEWARD.

ANSON BURLINGAME, Esq., *&c., &c., &c.*

No. 7.

Mr. Seward to Mr. Adams.

No. 2055.] DEPARTMENT OF STATE,
Washington, September 16, 1867.

SIR: Information has been received here from the United States consul at Amoy, China, to the effect that on the 26th of March last Commander Broad, of her Britannic Majesty's sloop-of-war Cormorant, with a view to the rescue of such of the survivors of the American bark Rover, wrecked near the southern coast of Formosa on the 12th of the last-named month, as might be left in the hands of the savages of that island, proceeded to the scene of this painful disaster, having on board a Chinaman, the only known survivor of the ill-fated crew.

On the arrival of Commander Broad at the place he discovered the Rover's small boat on the beach, and in attempting to land a force from the Cormorant was fired on from the jungle, which was so dense that it was found to be impossible, with the limited number of men at his command, to penetrate therein, and consequently the expedition was abandoned. It is proper to state that Charles Carroll, esq., the British consul at Taiman, Formosa, kindly interested himself in the matter, and accompanied the expedition for the purpose of rendering such assistance as might be in his power.

Under these circumstances I have to request that you will avail yourself of an early opportunity to express to her Majesty's government in fitting terms the high appreciation entertained by this government of the generous and humane conduct of Commander Broad and Consul Carroll on that occasion.

I am, sir, your obedient servant,

WILLIAM H. SEWARD.

CHARLES FRANCIS ADAMS, Esq., &c., &c., &c.

No. 8.

Mr. Seward to Mr. Burlingame.

No. 215.] DEPARTMENT OF STATE,
Washington, September 20, 1867.

SIR: Your despatch of the 19th of June last, No. 142, enclosing a copy of your note of the 18th of the same month to J. McLeary Brown, her Majesty's chargé d'affaires at Peking, acknowledging the services of Charles Carroll, esq., Commander Broad, and the officers and crew of her Britannic Majesty's steamer Cormorant, in their courageous and prompt attempt to rescue the captain and crew of the American bark Rover, was duly received, and is cordially approved.

Mr. Adams, our minister at London, was some time since instructed to make suitable acknowledgments to all of the British officers and subjects who took part in the friendly proceedings referred to.

I am, sir, your obedient servant,

WILLIAM H. SEWARD.

ANSON BURLINGAME, Esq., &c., &c., &c.

No. 9.

Mr. Adams to Mr. Seward.

No. 1464.] LEGATION OF THE UNITED STATES,
London, October 16, 1867.

SIR: On the reception of your despatch No. 2055, of the 16th of September, I addressed a note of thanks to Lord Stanley in recognition of the efforts of Commander Broad and Mr. Consul Carroll to rescue the crew of the American bark Rover, wrecked at the island of Formosa. Copies of that letter and of his lordship's acknowledgments are transmitted herewith.

I have the honor to be, sir, your obedient servant,

CHARLES FRANCIS ADAMS.

Hon. WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State, Washington, D. C.

Mr. Adams to Lord Stanley.

LEGATION OF THE UNITED STATES,
London, October 11, 1867.

MY LORD: From information officially received by the government which I have the honor to represent, it appears that, on the 16th of March last, Commander Broad, of her Majesty's sloop-of-war Cormorant, with a view to the rescue of such of the survivors of the American bark Rover (wrecked four days before near the southern coast of Formosa) as might have fallen into the hands of the savages of that island, proceeded to the scene of this disaster, having on board a Chinaman as a guide, the only known relic of the crew.

On the arrival of Commander Broad at the place designated, the small boat of the Rover was discovered on the beach; but, on an attempt to land a force, a fire was received from a jungle so dense as to render it impossible to penetrate it with his small number of men, hence it became necessary to abandon the expedition. It is proper to add that Charles Carroll, esq., the British consul at Taiwan, kindly interested himself in the matter, and actually accompanied the force for the purpose of rendering all the assistance in his power.

Under these circumstances, I am instructed to seize an early opportunity to express, through your lordship, to her Majesty's government the high appreciation entertained by my government of the generous and humane conduct of Commander Broad and Consul Carroll on this occasion.

I pray your lordship to accept, &c.,

CHARLES FRANCIS ADAMS.

The Right Hon. LORD STANLEY, *&c., &c., &c.*

Lord Stanley to Mr. Adams.

FOREIGN OFFICE, *October* 15, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your note of the 11th instant, relative to the wreck of the Rover, and I beg to express to you the satisfaction with which her Majesty's government have learnt the assistance which the consul at Taiwan and Commander Broad were enabled to offer, though unhappily without a successful result, on that occasion.

I have the honor, &c.,

STANLEY.

CHARLES FRANCIS ADAMS, Esq., *&c., &c., &c.*

No. 10.

Mr. Ford to Mr. Seward.

WASHINGTON, *January* 20, 1868.

SIR: Her Majesty's consul at Canton, in bringing to the notice of her Majesty's government the barbarous treatment practiced on shipwrecked crews by the savage tribes inhabiting the southern end of the island of Formosa, has transmitted to England an extract from the Hong Kong newspaper, the China Mail, of the 11th of November last.

A detailed account is therein given of the steps taken by General LeGendre, the United States consul at Amoy, on learning the disastrous events that ensued on the landing of a party of men from the United States man-of-war Hartford, whilst seeking reparation for the massacre of the shipwrecked crew of the American vessel Rover.

The measures inaugurated by General LeGendre would appear to have resulted in bringing the savage tribes to terms, and to a guarantee being given for the safety and protection of foreigners who may in future be shipwrecked on that coast.

In doing myself the honor of addressing to you the present note, I am authorized by my government to state that they have heard with pleasure of the benefit conferred on the maritime interests of all foreign nations by the energetic measures of the United States consul.

I have the honor to be, with the highest consideration, sir, your most obedient, humble servant,

FRANCIS CLARE FORD.

Hon. WILLIAM H. SEWARD, *&c., &c., &c.*

No. 11.

Mr. Seward to Mr. Ford.

DEPARTMENT OF STATE,
Washington, January 23, 1868.

MY DEAR SIR: Your note of the 20th instant, containing some allusions to the proceedings which were adopted by General LeGendre, United States consul at Amoy, for the protection of seamen against the violence of the savage tribes in Formosa, has given much pleasure to this department; first, because it gives what appears to be a probable account of the success of the consul's proceedings in that case; second, because it conveys an assurance of generous appreciation of the consul's proceedings on the part of her Majesty's government. Our latest official information was of the 4th of September, 1867. We are indebted to the telegram and to your note for the full information we have of facts subsequent to that date. I shall have occasion to recur to the subject after obtaining more conclusive information.

I am, my dear sir, very faithfully yours,

WILLIAM H. SEWARD.

FRANCIS CLARE FORD, Esq., *&c., &c., &c.*

No. 12.

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward.

No. 17.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,
Amoy, April 1, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor to bring to your immediate knowledge an extract of a despatch just received (enclosure No. 1) from Mr. McPhail, of Formosa, and conveying to me the painful intelligence of the murder of 13 Americans.

I shall leave at once for the seat of the occurrence, availing myself of the presence, at Foochow, of the United States gunboat Ashuelot to strengthen my hands in the measures I may be compelled to take to obtain redress and compensation from the local authorities of the island.

I advise the minister at Peking of the affair, asking for instruction as to future steps.

This painful news reached me as I was furnishing a special report of the Coolie case, tried in this court during the quarter ended March 31, 1867, which I had hoped to send you by this mail; I shall do so by the next French mail. This case appears, however, in the usual quarterly report sent to the department through the consulate general.

I have the honor to be, sir, your obedient servant,

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Hon. WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State, Washington, D. C.

Extract of letter of Mr. McPhail, of Formosa.

About 10 days ago the American bark Rover, from Swatow, bound to Neuchwang, in ballast, was wrecked on the "Bashas." The crew, 14 in all, made their way to a place called "Pang Livio," about 20 miles from Tachow, in the long boat, where they were all murdered by the savages, except one who has arrived at Takow.

No. 13.

Mr. Allen to Mr. Seward.

[Extract.]

[No. 22.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,
Hong Kong, April 7, 1867.

SIR: For some days past rumors of the most painful nature have been reaching us concerning the loss of the American ship Rover, off the island of Formosa Our worst fears in that regard are now even surpassed by the circumstantial information communicated through the columns of the "China Mail," a daily journal published here. And, as the information thus communicated comes direct from a gentleman attached to her Britannic Majesty's steamer Cormorant, which vessel visited the scene of the catastrophe, I deem the information entirely reliable; and deeming it probable that no more authentic or circumstantial account of the disastrous event can ever be obtained than this now given, I have thought it advisable to lay the same before the department in the manner communicated by the correspondent himself. I therefore append hereunto the statement as published in the newspaper above referred to:

[From the China Mail, Hong Kong, April 6, 1867.]

WRECK OF THE ROVER OFF FORMOSA.—MURDER OF THE CAPTAIN, HIS WIFE, AND CREW.—ATTACK BY THE NATIVES ON THE BOATS OF HER MAJESTY'S STEAMER CORMORANT.

A correspodent has favored us with the following letter relating to the above events. The concluding paragraph of it deserves the serious attention of all who are interested in insuring the safety of commerce in the China seas. Her Majesty's steamer Icarus left Foochow on the 3d instant for the scene of the wreck:

"TAKAO, FORMOSA, *March* 30, 1867.

"*To the Editor of the China Mail:*

"SIR: I regret to have to communicate to you the wreck off the south point of this island of the American bark Rover, on her voyage from Swatow to Neuchwang, under circum-

stances which leave no doubt that her crew were foully murdered by the savage natives of that place.

"The news was brought here by a Swatow Chinaman, who alone was fortunate enough to escape, and who arrived at Takow on the 22d instant. His story was that the vessel left Swatow on the 9th instant, and struck on rocks (evidently the Vele Rete rocks) on the 12th. She floated off, but in a sinking condition, and the master (Captain Hunt) determined to abandon her. The crew took to the boats and were divided as follows: The captain, his wife, one mate and three Chinese in one boat, the other mate and seven Chinese in the other. They pulled northwards, but during the night were parted. The first boat sighted land after 17 hours pulling, and its occupants landed and sat down on the beach. After sitting about half an hour they were surprised by a discharge of fire-arms from the bush close by, directed on to their party. Without waiting to see the result of this volley the Chinaman fled and hid himself till night, when he crossed the hills and reached Leangkiaou, a Chinese village, whence, after a delay of six days, he got passage to Takow in a sanpan. On receiving this intelligence, Captain Broad, in command of her Majesty's steamer Cormorant, which happened to be in port, at once decided upon steaming down the coast, and if possible to ransom any of the crew who might have survived.

"The Cormorant left Takao on the morning of the 25th, having on board Mr. Carroll, her Majesty's acting consul for Formosa, and Dr. Manson of Takao, who joined the expedition as a volunteer. She first anchored at Leangkiaou, where arrangements were made for sending a conciliatory message to the savages, with promises of rewards for any lives saved. A Chinaman, who understood the savage dialect, was also persuaded with great difficulty and under promise of good payment to act as interpreter. About 4 p. m. the ship anchored in the bay at the extreme point of the island, where on the beach were to be seen the remains of the boat from which the unfortunate crew had landed.

"Being desirous of giving the messenger from Langkiaou time to reach the savages, and so to avoid taking them by surprise, no one landed during the afternoon nor until 9 o'clock on the morning of the 26th, when the whaler, the gig and the cutter, were ordered to be prepared.

"In the first were Captain Broad, Mr. Consul Carroll, and the native interpreters; in the second, Lieutenant Mathias and Dr. Lucas, the surgeon, and in the third Lieutenant Ryder and Dr. Manson. The two first pulled ashore to where the Rover's boat was lying, and the cutter lay on her oars about thirty yards from the shore with orders to keep a lookout for any hostile movement. Everything however appeared quiet, no natives to be seen save on the hills about 300 yards from shore. A few buffaloes had also made their appearance on another part of the beach, with what object did not appear, and in charge of no one.

"Lieutenant Mathias was the first to jump ashore, and Captain Broad was in the act of doing the same, when a sharp fire of musketry was opened upon the party from two points in the jungle at not 20 yards distance. The abrupt nature of the sand-beach at this spot, however, prevented this first volley from taking effect on the whaler and gig.

"The position of the foe being only indicated by the smoke from their muskets, and they themselves being quite hidden in the dense bush, Captain Broad wisely determined not to risk the lives of his men in the pursuit of an invisible enemy in a jungle, where every advantage would have been on their side. The boats were therefore ordered off, the retreat being covered by the cutter, from which was kept up a fire which, from the cries of the savages, evidently told. Their bullets and arrows however now fell thickly round the boats, all of which were struck in several places, one ball passing right through both sides of the whaler only a few inches below the seat on which were sitting Captain Broad and Mr. Carroll.

"It is a cause for great congratulation, therefore, that the only casualty was a flesh wound received by one of the blue jackets in the cutter. In the same boat the stock of one of the marines' rifles was shot through as he was in the act of firing it.

"As no doubt now remained as to the sad fate of the Rover's crew nothing could be done but to inflict some punishment on their murderers. On returning to the ship therefore a fire of shell was opened upon the thickets, out of which they now ventured. The effects were soon visible, large parties being seen to hurry up the hills in the rear of the position they had occupied. At the two points alone whence fire was opened there could not have been less than 50 men, while I feel convinced that others were stationed all along the bay, the buffaloes being only a decoy to entice the crew ashore.

"To explain this I must state that the one and great object of life of a Formosan savage is to obtain heads, and I doubt not that they were greatly disappointed at not getting a few from the Cormorant. They fired not long ago into the boats of the Swallow, and I feel convinced that the crews of half the sailing vessels which have been lost and never heard of, on their way northward from Hong Kong, have perished at this spot. The very cunning of their ambuscade in this instance proves that they are adepts, and the lives of the whole party are probably due to some accident, such as one excited man having fired his musket too soon. Had they waited two minutes longer not a man in the whaler and gig could have escaped, and even as it was their escape appears miraculous. Masters of vessels leaving Hong Kong should be specially warned on no account to land at this spot, the more so now, as the sight of a foreign made boat lying on the beach might induce them to do so

"It is much regretted that these savage tribes should be allowed to hold possession of this

beautiful and valuable anchorage, situated as it is so conveniently for northward bound vessels in the northeast monsoon, and it would be a great boon to commerce could they be cleared out and a settlement of Chinese encouraged in their place. The hills are fertile and undulating, and the soil appears rich enough amply to repay the labor of cultivation. The climate in the winter is healthy and invigorating; and the summer would be cooled by the breezes of the southwest. As a sanatarium for the worn-out inhabitants of Hong Kong it would be unequalled. The mission of the Cormorant was intended as one essentially of peace and mercy, but with the experience now gained, and with a force sufficiently strong, a single well organized attack would drive the savages from the coast, and a few years of government protection would do the rest. I trust that the matter may be ere long taken up in the proper quarter and effectually carried out. The importance of the question affects not alone the English, the American, or any other nation, but touches all who are in any way connected with China—either its trade or its government."

* * * * * * * * *

I have the honor to remain, most respectfully, your obedient servant,

ISAAC J. ALLEN,
United States Consul.

Hon. WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State.

No. 14.

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward.

No. 19.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,
Amoy, China, May, 1867.

SIR: Refering to my despatch No. 17, I beg to state that I arrived at Foo-Chow-Foo on the 2d of April last. I immediately secured an interview with his excellency the viceroy of the Tohkien Providence, to whom I read the communication of Mr. McPhail, of Formosa, (enclosure No. 1 in my despatch to your honor No. 17,) at the same time respectfully calling his attention to articles XI and XIII of the treaty of Tientsin, (18th June, 1858,) and finally requesting him to order the civil and military authorities of Formosa to immediately rescue, if possible, such of the survivors of the Rover's crew that might yet remain in the hands of the aborigines, and to inflict just punishment, with the utmost vigor, on the perpetrators of the murder of our citizens.

His excellency complied at once with my request. (Enclosure No. 1.)

Having been detained in Taensai, I reached Taiwanfoo, with the United States steamer Ashuelot, Commander Febriger, on the 18th of April, when I wrote to the authorities of the island. (Enclosure No. 2.)

In answer to my despatch the following day I received joint communications from the Taotai, general and prefect, the highest official of the island. (Enclosure No. 3.)

I secured an interview with those officers, whom I visited jointly with Commander Febriger, on the 19th. We were received with the utmost cordiality and the greatest distinction; but the general, although promising to send a force to the seat of the tragedy, declined to avail himself of the presence of our forces to effect a landing of his troops. He remarked with reason that, having the responsibility of the operation, he should conduct it with perfect independence of action. I observed that some of the unfortunate might then be yet in the hands of the aborigines, and that no time should be lost in rescuing them. To which the Taotai answered that he *knew* from certain and official source that all of the wrecked crew of the Rover had been murdered. I remarked to the Taotai and the general that, from my own experience of war operations, I would judge the landing of a force under cover of the Ashuelot's guns so safe that I would not hesitate one instant to land with the Chinese troops if they were only ordered to proceed at once to the seat of the tragedy. Captain Febriger offered

them to tow the junks carrying the troops. To which the general said that his troops were not ready. I asked him when they would be ready, that Captain Febriger and myself might wait a few days. The general then very politely remarked that he would be happy to have our company at any time, but that he desired to do whatever would have to be done in this case alone; that the Chinese forces were adequate to the task before them, and that, although much obliged to Captain Febriger and myself for our offers, he would respectfully decline accepting them. We then left, thanking those officers for their reception, but emphatically stating that the United States would insist upon the strict observance of the treaty.

Just before we left the prefect wrote us that he had again called the attention of the Taotai and of the general upon the importance of immediately sending troops against the aborigines.

In Takao I visited her Britannic Majesty's vice-consul, to whom I showed a copy of his despatch (this copy left at Takao) to the Taotai of Formosa, in which he claims the Rover as an English vessel. He promised to rectify this error (of linguist) at an early date by writing to the Taotai a letter that would explain how it happened. The vice-consul kindly furnished me with a sketch of the bay where the Rover's crew were murdered, and which I immediately handed over to Captain Febriger. The vice-consul also told me that the Chinese authorities of Formosa *had so far failed to take any steps towards rescuing* the wrecked crew of the Rover and punishing the murderers of such as were reported to have lost their lives by the hands of the aborigines, (22d of April.)

At Tang-Kaion bay, the last Chinese village (24th) south of Takao, Captain Febriger and myself examined the chief of the settlement in his own house. The chief said that he had furnished Captain Broad, of her Britannic Majesty's sloop Cormorant, with pilots and interpreters when he went on the 26th of March to the seat of the occurrence; that we could have the same pilots, but not the interpreters; this interpreter had returned some time since confirming the murder of all and every one of the crew of the bark Rover by the aborigines; he (the chief) said also, that *so far the Chinese authorities had not sent forward any force* against the aborigines, or any one to inquire about the circumstances of the murder, (24th April.)

Captain Febriger concluded to have the pilots offered to him, and we proceeded south; we came to an anchor opposite the scene of the murder without the least difficulty. A small junk that was at anchor was hauled in, and four of her crew were examined by Captain Febriger and myself. (Enclosure No. 4.)

Evidently those men were not sincere and belong to a class of Chinese living on the coast in various Chinese villages, from Takao to the extreme south of the island, and who furnish shot, powder, and guns to the aborigines, who pay them back in wood. Yet as the Chinese government might have after claimed them to be their spies, sent there in view of future military operations connected with the wreck of the Rover, I did not judge it advisable to arrest, but in conjunction with Captain Febriger I requested them to communicate with the aborigines for the purpose of securing the burial of the remains of our unfortunate countrymen, and the purchase of such as might remain of their effects or valuables, and for which I promised to pay a liberal price, if ever forwarded to me or handed over when I would return. They promised that they would do their best to comply with my desire, but they emphatically refused to send me to shore when I had the strongest desire to venture as a peaceful negotiator with one capable of acting as an interpreter. They repeatedly answered, that should they make such an attempt they would be murdered by the aborigines.

The bay at this point is navigable for any boat, but chiefly to steamers of light draught, like the Ashuelot, but very few rocks were noticeable, if we except reefs that outcrop at low water here and there near the shore. Under cover of guns, even a very small party of men could land at any point, and to the westward of the bay a force might be thrown on shore at any time and inde-

pendently of the ship's protection, the ground there being bare and having commanding heights near at hand, which extending all along the banks of the bay, could afford a commanding road to the shore, at the centre of the bay. Then the exact position of the aborigines' village being ascertained, the landed force might advance, without fear of any serious obstacle, towards the settlements that would undoubtedly be the object of the expedition.

From my actual observation, I am prepared to say that the shore of the bay is settled by a mixed race, a cross-breed of aborigines and Chinese, most of whom wear tails, as the Chinese themselves do, and my impression is that the various settlements which that race have made along the coast, and which appear to the eye to be a few huts scattered on the flats and on the low grounds, form a mere veil to conceal the presence of the aborigines at that point. Although this mixed race affects to be in a state of constant warfare with the aborigines, I am satisfied that they kept closely connected with them, by taking each other's women for wives, by trading with them, and assisting them in their plunder and crimes, appearing afterwards as mere victims and witnesses to the strength and power of their would be enemies, and bring it as a sort of bug-bear to the Chinese or other nations that might propose to land with a view of their total extermination.

It is universally admitted that the bay at the southern coast of the island of Formosa is a point that should be kept clear from such horde; for it is the only point, with few others situated on the western shore, extending ten miles toward the north to Loo-choo bay, that offers a sort of natural refuge on that inhospitable coast. The eastern coast of Formosa is extremely high, and falls down abruptly like a sort of rampart into the waters of the ocean, and that extends to the north as the backbone of the island.

How many unfortunate that left Hong Kong and were never heard of, being reported to have been lost at sea, were murdered on that shore? and how many more will be, until prompt and efficient measures are taken to stop the evil?

On the 24th of April we weighed our anchors, arriving in Amoy on the 26th at 9 a. m. I received there a copy of the examination of Teh-Kwang, the only known survivor of the crew of the bark Rover, sent to me by the United States consul at Swatow, (enclosure No. 5.) I had already left Amoy when Teh-Kwang arrived there, on board of her Britannic Majesty's Cormorant, and Mr. E. M. Smith, the deputy consul, had neglected to examine the man.

In connection with the foregoing, I beg to offer to your excellency the following conclusion:

1st. That so far, in concert with Captain Febriger, acting under the orders of Rear-Admiral Bell, I have simply urged upon the Chinese authorities at Foo-Chow and Formosa to rescue such of the survivors of the Rover's crew that might yet be in the hands of the aborigines, according to article XI and XIII of the treaty of Tientsin, and to do something that could be considered by the United States as sufficient punishment of these wild tribes for the past, and an efficient warning for the future.

2d. No other efforts were made by Captain Febriger and myself to secure the prompt action of the Chinese government in that direction, for we feared by interfering in the least way with the movements of the Chinese officials, they might claim as a redeeming point of their inaction our own intervention, and as a sequence prevent your excellency from hereafter claiming indemnities for the families of such of the Rover's crew that might have been saved, if the Chinese had been more prompt in allowing them the relief they were entitled by treaty to receive from the Formosa authorities.

I have the honor to be, sir, your obedient servant,

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Hon. WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State, Washington, D. C.

The Taotai and Prefect of Foo-Chow to the Prefect of Formosa.

I beg to inform you that on the 5th day of the 3d moon (9th April) the United States consul general, General LeGendre, called on our excellency, the governor and viceroy, stating that the winds blew to the port of Takoa, and the wild people killed more than 14 men, Americans. The consul, LeGendre, takes a man-of-war there to manage this case, and he requests him, the viceroy, to give orders to the local authorities of Formosa to assist the consul to conduct these negotiations.

The viceroy says that in consequence of the consul not writing an official letter he cannot write officially. The viceroy orders us to write you, when the consul goes to Formosa you will try to investigate this case immediately. Find out all the truth to report to the Taotai, and let the Taotai order the civil and military officers to search and seize every one, and report to them, and to carry out the government law, so that we keep friendly with other nations.

If the consul takes measures to manage the case himself, please invite him not to do so, for those savages might give him more trouble than he thinks.

Full respects to you and regards. I hope you will give a satisfactory answer.

Your young brother,

NUG-SEA-MUIG, *Lee-Kueg-Lin.*

UNITED STATES CONSULATE,
Amoy, May 10, 1867.

A true copy of the original, word for word.

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE.
United States Consul.

CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES AT AMOY,
On board the United States Steamer Ashuelot,
13*th of the* 3*d moon, April* 19, 1867.

SIRS: I have been informed that the American bark Rover, on the 12th March, 1867, (2d moon, 7th day,) ran upon a rock upon the southern coast of Formosa, and was so much injured that to save their lives the crew were obliged to take to the boats.

The master, his wife, the second mate, and three sailors escaped in the first boat and landed on the southwest point of the island, about 50 miles south of Takao, where they are reported to have all been murdered, with the exception of one Chinese sailor, who escaped.

The second boat, with first mate and seven sailors, is supposed to have landed in the same locality and to have met with the same fate.

The Chinese who escaped from the first boat came to Amoy, at the consulate, and gave intelligence of the tragedy. I have sent him to his home, Swatow, at the expense of the United States. I now come to request that immediate investigation be made of this case, and if any of the crew of the bark Rover are in the hands of the natives that they be immediately recovered and delivered over into my hands; also that all persons implicated in the outrage be seized and punished in accordance with your laws as prescribed by articles XI and XIII of the last treaty concluded between the United States and the empire of China. Captain Febriger, commander of the United States steamer Ashuelot, informs me that in case you require any assistance he will be glad to join you in the efforts you make towards this end. I shall be very glad to hear that you have accepted his offer.

Respectfully submitted:

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE,
Consul of the United States for Amoy and Dependencies.

Their honors the GENERAL PREFECT and the TAOTAI of TAIWANFOO,
Island of Formosa.

His excellency the viceroy and governor of the Fohkien province requested me to hand over to you a letter from the high authorities of Foo-Chow, relating to this affair. I shall be happy to deliver it when I have the honor of meeting you.

The General Lin, Taotai Wee, and the Prefect of Taiwanfoo to General Le Gendre, United States consul.

TAIWANFOO, *April* 19, 1867.

SIR: We received your letter of the 18th April, stating (here follows copy of consul's letter of 17th April, see enclosure No. 2.)

The Taotai states that on the 23d ultimo he received a despatch from her Britannic Majesty's consul, Mr. Carroll, stating that a British vessel on her way to Lan-chio had struck on a rock near "Red Head" island, and that 14 men were obliged to take a boat to Loong-chiao bay, called by the natives Ku-wah-lu Peh Suau; that on landing 13 men were killed and one escaped; that the latter on reaching Mian a Kau was assisted by an official with a cargo boat to proceed to Takao, when he visited the British consulate.

The Taotai states that on receiving this despatch he immediately requested Colonel Lin and the district magistrate to accompany soldiers to the spot indicated and inquire into the matter, ordering that none of the people be allowed to visit the natives (aborigines) and cause trouble. On the 3d instant these two officers report that they went to Get-bu to examine and take action in the case, and also to see the British consul, Carroll, and the commissioner of customs, White, who agreed in stating that the aborigines resemble wild beasts, and cannot comprehend the usages of civilized society. Further, that the savages conceal themselves in the forest and country, open fire upon those who approach, thus making it exceedingly difficult to employ troops, &c., &c. Again Mr. Carroll wrote a letter of thanks, a copy of which we now send for your information.

On receipt of information relative to the massacre of the master and crew of the Rover by the savages prior to your arrival, we issued directions to the civil and military authorities to adopt measures for the management of the affair; but the savages live in a wild state in the hills, and it is difficult to employ soldiers against them, as the British consul and all others well know, and as they are like apes, and their country is unsurveyed. They are not subject to the Chinese government; hence the Chinese government has from early times forbidden commercial intercourse with them, or to enter their country, and on the borders at the passes are placed guards to prevent these fierce savages from passing to and fro. Now, in the case of this vessel, which unsuspectedly entered the place, and whose crew suffered from ignorance, if any execution of zeal can do it, no endeavor will be spared to bring the offenders to immediate and condign punishment, in order that terms of good fellowship and harmony may exist between China and the foreign powers. We cannot dare to trouble you for the military (or naval) assistance in the matter, since in the event of any accident we should feel more than ever grievous. We have again directed the civil and military authorities to despatch troops and constabulary to carry on operations. We would not request the presence of your man-of-war to assist us in these operations.

We have, &c.

Statement of four Chinamen, examined by both Captain Febriger and the United States consul of Amoy.

AMOY, *May* 10, 1867.

There are four men in the junk; the junk is from Taiwanfoo; left Taiwanfoo ten days ago; anchored below Tacao, place named Pang-Leoir; is a Chinese

village; was there eight days ago. When he left Taiwanfoo had cotton goods, which they disposed of at Lun-Kein to Chiend, [who] gave them a letter to buy wood; the letter was addressed to the interpreter of the Indians named Moöe; he is a Canton man; lives a mile away; the boat belongs to Nougo-Kantinlinig in Taiwanfoo. The junk can go into the jetty. The order of Chiend on Nougo paid for the wood. They are now waiting here for the wind to cease; they have two guns. The half-breed brought the wood to the boat; [the name of the captain] cannot talk savage; talks Amoy; Gho Khwan is his name.

SECOND MAN.

Naugh-Poo; belongs to the Pescadores; is from Taiwanfoo; has been to Pang-Leoir; anchored at Lun-Kein harbor; a few pieces of goods was his cargo; sold the goods to Chiend; he (Chiend) told him to get the wood through Moöe; Moöe brought the wood to the boats; does not know if all the men were understood or not. Tung-Tung is the captain of the boat; has been near Amoy, and also to Taiwanfoo. There are Chinese living here; cannot correspond with them; they are going to bring their load to Taiwanfoo; they hire the boat from Noug-Kan-Tin. The captain pays them $3 50 for pilots, and $2 50 per month for mariners.

THIRD MAN.

Lee-Tung; is from Taiwanfoo; he got some money to buy some wood; had no cargo; Chiend gave him the money; Chiend lives in Taiwonfoo; [the owner of the boat,] Noug-Kan-Tin; Moöe sold the wood to him for 18,000 cash; he saw Moöe on the land; does not know if Moöe is a Chinaman or not; he looks like a Canton man. He [Lee-Tung] took the wood on shore partially, and part was brought to him on bamboo lampans; did not know anything about Moöe; saw him on shore, and offered him the wood for sale; he bought the wood yesterday; had no cotton goods; stopped at Pang-Leoir to get water and rice; it is customary to get wood here.

FOURTH MAN.

Koo-Pang; belongs to the boat; gets $2 per month as wages; is from Taiwanfoo; has nothing on board, no goods; stopped at Hong-Kong, below Pang-Leoir; arrived here eight days ago; bought wood from Kau-Soo-Moöe, a Canton man. Moöe will sell wood at 5 cash one bundle; that is the price; three bundles weigh about seven pounds.

A true copy:

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Statement of the Chinaman Tek-Kwang, belonging to Mee-O, in the Kittyang district, taken by the United States consul at Swatow, with the assistance of Rev. William Ashmore as interpreter.

SWATOW, *April* 9, 1867.

I shipped at the United States consulate, February 28, 1867, on the bark Rover. Sailed from the port Saturday morning, March 9th. Had stiff winds and were under close-reefed topsails. At about 11 o'clock on the night of Tuesday, March 12th, we struck a rock on the larboard side Had seen Formosa the evening before, and were keeping off. When we struck we at once backed the sails, after which she slid off the rock, went a little distance, and then struck on the other side. The captain shifted the helm and then she began to move. The captain then set the men to the pumps, but no water came; they would not draw. I think the pumps were injured by the blow; they were in good order before. The captain sent the first mate down with a light into the hold; he found that the water was already over the ballast. The captain

ordered the boats; we all got into two boats; the captain's had six in it, himself, his wife, the second mate, myself, another sailor and the cook. There was taken in the boat a bedquilt and some clothing, some water, a little food, a small quantity of spirit, a compass and sextant; Mrs. Hunt took a small box. The second boat had in it the first mate, the cabin boy, five sailors, and the sailors' cook. We pushed off about one o'clock; we kept in company, rowing until daylight. We staid on board as long as we could; the water was getting so high that we were afraid to stay any longer. At daylight we saw Formosa; we rowed in until about 4 o'clock p. m., the tide also setting us in; when we landed we saw no one. The captain told us that he thought we need not fear, but we must get ashore to save our lives. About 10 o'clock we lost sight of the second boat. We pulled the boat up to the shore; we took on shore all there was in the boat; our clothes were wet; we took them off, wrung out the water and laid them out to dry. The captain sent me to find some fresh water; I found it and brought some back, a bucket full. The place where we landed was a sand beach at the foot of a mountain, very densely wooded. While we were drying our clothes the savages came out of the jungle to the number of 15 or 16; there were one or two women among them, with long dresses and earrings; the men had no clothing but the breech cloth. When they came out of the bushes they were armed; some had guns; some had knives, some had bows and arrows; the captain called out to take to the bush. At once some of the natives ran to where our things were; others pursued us into the bushes. I hid myself into the bushes; I heard them pursuing; the savages made a great noise calling out; I heard several guns fired; I do not know certainly whether they got any one or not; after a while I saw them come back and divide the plunder; then they went back the way they came. After all was still I came out; I called several times the names of the captain and others; no answer came Then I found some biscuit, which the savages had rejected, which I took. When night came on I started off, making my way westward; I had a moon until 10 o'clock. The next morning at daylight I went to where some Chinese were. The Chinese settlement was not more than nine or twelve miles (English) away. I got to this Chinese settlement and told what had happened, and got a man to go and beg the savages not to kill them but let them be ransomed. I had no money to hire this man, but the kind people contributed about $3 to hire him. The man was a Chinaman, the only one that ventures among them; this man is a Chinaman's son by one of their women. The man went and came back the next afternoon, with word that five of the captain's boat were murdered the afternoon of the attack. He also brought word that the other boat had arrived in the night, and the next morning two of them were killed. After three days I came to Taikoo; I went to the English consul; he sent a man to make inquiries about the other six men. The man came back with a report that two more men had been killed. The English consul sent a steamer and I went along with it. The boat was still there but all destroyed, the bottom was knocked out. Three boats went ashore from the steamer with 30 or 40 men. While they were making a landing for the officers, I having gone on shore first, was fired upon; there were 30 or 40 shots fired, all in quick succession; the captain ordered the men back; one man was slightly wounded in his stomach. There were no arms in the Rover's boats. The man-of-war brought me to Amoy. I arrived in Amoy the 31st day of March.

A true copy:

T. C. A. HINYORTS,
United States Consul

AMOY, *May* 11, 1867.

A true copy.

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

No. 15.

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward.

No. 20.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,
Amoy, China, May 11, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor to bring to your notice (art. 576, Consular Manual,) that on the 26th of March, 1867, and with a view to rescue such of the survivors of the American bark Rover, wrecked near the southern coast of Formosa, on the 12th of March last, that might be left in the hands of the aborigines. Commander Broad, of her Britannic Majesty's sloop-of-war Cormorant, having the only known survivor of the crew on board, (a Chinaman,) started for the scene of this painful occurrence.

Commander Broad found the place, and saw the Rover's small boat still on the beach, but, in attempting to land, was fired on from the jungle, which was so dense that it would have been folly to attempt to penetrate it, and the boats returned to the ship. A few shells drove the aborigines from the cover of the jungle to the higher and more open ground beyond; but nothing further was attempted, the force that Commander Broad had at his command being quite inadequate to the task. In this attempt Alfred Flagg, A. B., standing by the side of Commander Broad, was wounded by a spent slug in the abdomen.

On hearing of this I immediately wrote to her Britannic Majesty's consul at this port requesting him to offer my sincerest thanks for the promptness, daring, and rare courage exhibited by Commander Broad on this occasion, stating that I would transmit a proper statement of these facts to you, to be laid before his Excellency the President of the United States, who alone could make suitable acknowledgment to Captain Broad and such of his crew who have especially distinguished themselves on this occasion, and whose names I begged him to furnish me with at an early date. Enclosure No. 1 is the copy of Commander Broad's answer to me, received through her Britannic Majesty's consul, with a list of those that were present when the commander's party were subjected to the fire of the Formosa Indians.

I have the honor to be, sir, your obedient servant,

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul at Amoy.

Hon. WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State, Washington, D. C.

Commander Broad to Mr. LeGendre.

HER MAJESTY'S SLOOP CORMORANT,
Amoy, April 29, 1867.

SIR: I have much pleasure in acknowledging the receipt of your very handsome approval of my services on behalf of the crew of the late American bark Rover, who had unfortunately fallen into the hands of some savage tribes on the island of Formosa on the 12th of March last.

While deeply sensible of the high encomiums which you have been pleased to express towards myself and those who acted with me on that occasion, I can only say that I was actuated with but one idea—that of saving life, and I deeply regret my efforts in this case were so unsuccessful.

You were kind enough to request the names "of those who especially distinguished themselves on that occasion." I therefore forward you herewith a

list of those who were employed in the boats of her Majesty's sloop on that service, one and all having been equally exposed to the same deadly and unforeseen attack from the savages.

I am, dear sir, yours, very respectfully,

GEORGE D. BROAD,
Commander.

General LEGENDRE,
United States Consul, Amoy.

List of the officers and men employed in the boats of H. M. sloop Cormorant, on the 12th March, 1867, who were exposed to the fire of the savage aborigines of Formosa.

Names.	Rank or rating.	Names.	Rank or rating.
WHALER.		John Hewlett	Ordinary seaman.
		Wm. H. Bulley...	Shipwright.
George D. Broad...	Commander.	George Haste.....	A. B.
Charles Carroll, esq.	H. B. M. acting consul for Formosa.	Thomas Henley...	A. B.
		*Alfied Flagg	A. B.
John Flynn.....	Captain's coxswain.	Robert Sewes.....	2d captain foretop.
John McCarthy....	Ordinary seaman.	Michael Hickey...	2d captain forecastle.
John Kerswell.....	Ordinary seaman.	George W. Lay...	Caulk water.
John Every.....	Ordinary seaman.	Francis Viney	Ordinary seaman.
James Grice.....	1st class boy.	William J. Lee...	Ordinary seaman.
		John White.....	Acting serg't R. M. A.
SECOND GIG.		FIRST CUTTER.	
Edgar R. Mathias..	Senior lieutenant.		
Leonard Lucas	Acting surgeon.	Harry L. Ryder ..	Lieutenant.
Colier H. Jones....	Midshipman.	†Doctor Manson..	Medical practitioner at Formosa.
George Sempers ...	A. B.		
John Morris.....	Ordinary seaman.	John Richardson..	2d captain maintop.
Richard Tozer.....	Ordinary seaman.	Isaac Barkwell ...	Corporal R. M.
John Bond.....	A. B	Henry Bookham..	Private R. M.
William Knowles..	Ordinary seaman.	William Hewlett..	Private R. M.
John Cunningham.	Stoker.	George D. Green..	Private R. M.
James McLean....	Stoker.	George Walker...	Gunner R. M. A.
William Gibbs.....	1st class boy.		

* Wounded by a spent slug in the abdomen. † Volunteer.

GEORGE D. BROAD,
Commander.

A true copy, word for word:

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE.

No. 16.

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward.

No. 21.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,
Amoy, China, May 11, 1867.

SIR: In conformity with article 573, Consul's Regulations, and as a complement of the information furnished in despatches 17 and 19, I have the honor to report that the bark Rover, wrecked on the 12th of March last, near the south end of the island of Formosa, cleared at Swatow, China, in ballast for Newchwang on March 2, 1867, and sailed a few days after.

She was owned and commanded by Captain Joseph W. Hunt, of Port Jefferson, Long Island, New York. Her crew consisted of W. Harris, of Pennsylvania, first officer; Jonas Asberg, of Sweden, second officer; a cook, seven seamen, all Chinese, belonging at the port of Swatow.

There were also on board Mrs. Mercy G. (Bearnom) Hunt, wife of the captain, and a Chinese servant, also belonging at the port of Swatow.

A bold, but unsuccessful, attempt to rescue such of the unfortunates as might be in the hands of the aborigines was made on the 26th of March, 1867, by Commander Broad, of her Britannic Majesty's sloop Cormorant.

I have the honor to be, sir, your obedient servant,

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul at Amoy.

Hon. WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State, Washington, D. C.

No. 17.

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward.

No. 22.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES,
Amoy, June 5, 1867.

SIR: Referring to my despatches Nos. 17, 19, and 21, relating to the wreck of the American bark Rover, I have the honor to hand to you, under this cover, enclosures Nos. 1 and 2, being press copies of the English translations of a despatch just received from the general and Taotai of the island of Formosa, and of my answer to it, both of which have been this day communicated to the United States minister at Peking.

I have the honor to be, sir, your obedient servant,

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Hon. WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State, Washington, D. C.

CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES,
Amoy, May 20, 1867.

I have the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your despatch of the 28th day, 3d moon, Tung-Chi, 6th year.

In answer I would state that I have spent two days at the southern bay of the island of Formosa, where the Rover's crew were murdered. There I saw small Chinese settlements said to be in close and daily communication with the aborigines reported to have murdered our countrymen. We came to anchor opposite the seat of the tragedy without the least difficulty, but now that the southwest monsoon is prevalent in this latitude, I doubt not that we would find the bay much less secure. Had you accepted the offer of Captain Febriger to convey your forces you could have operated a landing without the least difficulty. Having neglected to avail yourself of this opportunity, you will find, no doubt, the task much more arduous.

While at anchor at the south bay we saw a small junk at anchor, and we had a conversation with the crew, composed of four men named Coo-Pang, Lee-Tung, Nagh-Poo, Gha-Kwan, the last named commanding the junk. I do not believe that those men gave us any correct information; yet they acknowledged to be from Tai-Wan-Foo, and to be connected by trade with the savages. We

should have arrested them, but as you requested us not to interfere in this affair, your desire being to settle it alone, we did not embarrass their movements and allowed them to go free. Evidently those men belong to a class of Chinese that furnish shot and powder to the aborigines, who pay them in wood. Moreover, I believe that the murderers of our countrymen are not wild savages, as you state, for all the people we saw on the southern bay have the appearance of Chinese, and, like them, wear tails. We could soon have ascertained the fact, but having agreed not to embarrass your movements, we did not even attempt to land.

You should also know that I have been informed that the only survivor of the Rover's crew having arrived at Lee-Chew bay, on the 14th March, sent a message to the reported murderers of our countrymen, and the man having returned the same day, announced that five of the crew were killed on the 15th March. He also brought word that the other boat had arrived on the night of the 13th, and that next morning two of the crew were killed. Another messenger, sent to inquire of the other six men, reported that two more had been killed. So far, you see, we have intelligence of the murder of only nine men, and I believe that the others, including the captain's wife, are held in bondage by the inhabitants of the southern bay.

I should also bring to your notice, that according to the last advices received by me from Foo-Chan-Kieng, no Chinese troops had been sent forward to the aborigines country.

Under the circumstances I should say that the sooner you punish the authors of the murder of our countrymen, and you afford relief to such of those who may yet remain in bondage in their hands, the better you will carry the provisions of articles XI and XIII of the treaty of Tientsin with the United States, and I take this opportunity to say again to you, that from the strict observance of the treaty on your part, as well as on ours, will depend the continuation of the friendly relations which, I am happy to say, exist between our two countries.

I am, &c.,

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

The GENERAL and TAOTAI *of Formosa.*

Translation of a despatch received from the Taotai and general of the island of Formosa, relative to the wreck of the American bark Rover, 28th day, 3d moon, Tung-chi, 6th year.

The general and Taotai of Formosa to the United States consul at Amoy:

I beg to state to you that on the 25th day, 3d moon, this year, Mr. Whow, the magistrate of Tau-shau-kieng, wrote to us the following:

On the 13th day of this moon, I have received the orders of your excellencies, and the letter of the United States consul Legendre; (here follow quotations of my despatch, being enclosure No. 2 to my despatch No. 19, to the State office, being enclosure No. 1 to my despatch No. 7 to your excellency;) also the communication of Captain Febriger, offering his co-operation.

You appointed me to proceed with a military officer to the spot where the Rover's crew were murdered, directing me at the same time to do all we should under the circumstances to keep friendship with the eastern natives according to the treaties. Some time since you communicated to me a despatch from Mr. Carroll, the British consul, and gave me orders accordingly, (here follows a resumé of Mr. Carroll's letter.) On receipt of this despatch, we had already placed ourselves in communication with Mr. Carroll and the commissioner of customs, Mr. White, to discuss various plans of action, and endeavored to induce them to join in whatever we might do in the case. Both gentlemen represented that the aborigines resemble wild animals, and like them are deprived of reasoning power, live in the forests, and hide themselves in the grass in ambuscade against any civilized beings that may land on their coast. The region inhabited by these tribes presents many obstacles to military operations.

We expressed the opinion to your excellencies that if the murderers are Chinese they should receive a punishment that should be a warning for the future to all, and to the Americans a sufficient satisfaction for the past, as the treaty prescribes. If, on the contrary, they belong to such tribes as do not recognize our authority, we should ascertain it, doing, under the circumstances, the best that we could to punish the guilty parties.

Our first impulse when we received your order was to proceed forthwith to the theatre of the tragedy, but our spies could not ascertain the length of the way by water and by land. They speak of numerous breakers in the Lin-kien bay, and they say that with the contrary winds (southwest monsoon) the sea is dangerous in the extreme, and even with a steamer. Small fishing-boats or trading craft are hardly manageable there. On this wild coast, covered with grass, and a natural refuge for wild animals and birds, indeed man has seldom appeared, and all consider it to be a very dangerous point.

Now we, Peu-Kuii, (civil officer,) Tai-Pau, and Foo-Chau, (military men,) have detailed a subordinate, (soldier named Pan-Chinie Whui,) with men to whom the region is familiar, to build a good encampment for our forces, and to guide us on our way onward, with a view to ascertain whether the Rover's crew have been killed in that place, known to us as being inhabited by tribes with whom our people are forbidden to hold communication of any kind, (in Chinese, where we do not even permit one of our cows to penetrate.)

I will find everything, and be in readiness to act. We will also prepare a map, which, being forwarded to your excellencies, will enable you to decide upon a plan of operation.

At all events, we shall prove that our government entertains the kindest feelings for the eastern nation. When all this shall be done, we will report to you again. We must let you know that our first column is ready, and that we are only awaiting your orders, which we shall be proud to obey.

On receipt of the foregoing despatch, we have ordered our subordinate to do what he considered to be the best under the circumstances.

WHOW, *&c.*, *&c.*

No. 18.

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward.

No. 23.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES,
Amoy, June 30, 1867.

SIR: Referring to my despatches Nos. 17, 19, 21, 22, relating to the wreck of the American bark Rover, I have the honor to hand you, under this cover, (enclosure No. 1,) being a despatch received from the Taotai and general of the island of Formosa, also my answer to the same, (enclosure No. 2.) Copies of enclosures Nos. 1 and 2 have been forwarded by me to the United States minister at Peking, and to the rear-admiral commanding the United States Asiatic squadron in Shanghai.

I have the honor to be, sir, with great respect, your obedient servant,

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

HON. WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State, Washington, D. C.

TAIWANFOO, *2d day, 5th moon, 6th year.*

To the United States Consul at Amoy:

We, General Lin and Taotaiou, beg to inform you that on the 24th day, 4th moon of this year, the magistrate of Fou-Sau-Kien, Mr. Whou, reported to us the following:

The former magistrate of Fou-Sau-Kien, Colonel Lin, and myself, having received a communication from the English consul, also a despatch from the United States consul, LeGendre, both relating to the wreck of the bark Rover and the murder of the crew at Caw-Cass-piss-any, also your order to send a force to the theatre of the tragedy, seize the guilty parties and turn them over to you for punishment. T. Penkicy and Colonel Lin and an escort of soldiers proceeded to Taikiao, giving notice to Consul Carroll and the Commissioner of Customs White. This has been communicated to you already. Subsequently, we having matured

our plans, Captain Pau-Whin-Whey furnished me with guides, and Colonel Lin collected a force of good seamen and experienced soldiers, and we made dispositions to advance with intent of ascertaining what could possibly be accomplished. We also directed a military officer, named Wang-lee-Whang, to make a map of the country, as we have already advised you. Now Captain Pang-Chang-Whin reported to me, (Whou,) and said that he had gone to the Liang-Kian bay, where he commenced an inquiry among the inhabitants, half castes, of that locality. There he learned that the place where the Rover's crew were killed is some 12 or 20 miles southward, and is entirely settled by savages, whose language none of them (i. e., the inhabitants of the Liang-Kian bay) know how to speak. The water route is rendered thoroughly impracticable by rocks in the seas as thick as the trees in the forest. The overland route is not less dangerous, it being infested by savages who hide themselves in the cavities of the rocks and in the grass, from which they fire upon their enemies. It was with the utmost difficulty that we succeeded in hiring spies to gain this information.

The Liang-Kian bay is within the limits of our jurisdiction, but its inhabitants are very few, and the country round is very thickly wooded. When the government wants wood, a linguist is sent there to buy it. But Kau-a Kau-piss-any is fifteen or twenty miles distant from Liang-Kian bay, and there are no roads communicating between the two points, only passes for wild animals and birds of prey; the whole country, being thickly covered with grass and trees, is very dangerous. The savages that live there hide themselves in caverns, going in and coming out of them like rats, and like them indiscernible.

We, Tin-Pan-Chin-Chang and Pin-Kiep, have examined the treaty. Articles 11 and 13 provide that whenever, within the jurisdiction of the Emperor of China, any one shall molest Americans, the military and civil authorities must, on hearing of the same, try to punish the authors.

But in this case the Americans were not murdered on Chinese territory, or on Chinese seas, but in a region occupied by the savages. Hence, the treaty cannot affect it at all. Was it in our power to seize those men we would gladly do so, and would not think of refusing, so that we might keep friendship with foreigners.

But the savage country does not come within the limits of our jurisdiction, and our military force is not able to operate in it. Such are the difficulties encountered by us, which we must make known to you in all candor, begging you, at the same time, to make the necessary allowance and favor us with an answer.

On the receipt of the foregoing, I determined to communicate it to you, having already sent you a former despatch received on the same subject. Our impression is that our agents have furnished us with a true statement of the case, and we believe those savages to be like wild animals, with whom any one would disdain to contend. A government as great and generous as yours will always despise such beings.

Respectfully submitted,

[Signed &c., &c., &c.]

UNITED STATES CONSULATE,
Amoy, June 22, 1867.

The foregoing is a true copy of the original on file at this office.

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

No. 72.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,
Amoy, June 22, 1867.

SIRS: I have the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your despatch of 2d day, 5th moon, 6th year, (3d of June, 1867.)

The sudden conclusion you have come to in the affair of the Rover, and the reasons you give thereof, disappoint me in the extreme and more than I could express.

You never seemed to doubt, either in the course of our interview or in our written communications, that the Rover had been wrecked on the Chinese seas, and her crew murdered on Chinese territory. If there was the shadow of uncertainty left in your mind on this point, why not have said so at once, or have settled the question by a glance over the map when Captain Febriger and myself called on you, on the 20th of April last, asking you to lend your aid

towards investigating this distressing affair. Then, and not now, was the proper time to present your objections or decline, as you do now, any interference in the affair. For then the monsoon was favorable to naval operations in the southern bay; then the hot weather had not set in; then we had our forces near the spot; then many of the unfortunate victims who, by this time, have doubtless perished through violence, exposure or starvation, were, I doubt not, living. The remains of those that have been murdered, since rendered unknowable by the action of time or scattered to the winds, could have been recovered and sent to their friends for sepulture. This we could have carried out through our own resources, and on our own responsibility, had we only known of your real intentions, and we would have reserved our rights for indemnity to be brought forward, in case your inaction had been found to have been due to a wrong understanding of your duties to our government, under the treaty and the laws of nations.

Instead of this you prayed us to do nothing, and said that you would do everything. In fact you wrote me—

> In receipt of information relative to the massacre of the master and crew of the bark Rover, by the savages, prior to your arrival, we have issued directions to the civil and military authorities to adopt measures for the management of the affair, * * * * and if any exertion of zeal can do it, no endeavors will be spared to bring the offenders to immediate punishment, in order that terms of good fellowship and harmony may exist between China and the foreign powers. We could not dare to trouble Captain Febriger and yourself for military and naval assistance in the matter, since, in the event of any accident, we would feel more than ever grieved. We have again directed the civil and military authorities to despatch troops and constabulary to carry on operations. We would not request the presence of your man-of-war to assist in these operations, &c., &c., &c. (Letter of General Lin, Taotai-wu, and prefect of Taiwaufoo to General LeGendre, United States consul, dated Taiwaufoo, 15th day, 3d moon, 6th year, April 19, 1867)

On the following day you renewed the same assurances of your desire to comply with our just request; and the general only required a few days to perfect his plans, his past experience of mountain warfare being limited; but he promised to act promptly, and simply asked for liberty to strike the blow alone. He said to me:

> If any force can bring these savages to terms, the Chinese soldiers are adequate to the task, but being alone responsible to my government for the success of the expedition, it is but just that I should conduct it with entire liberty of action, and I decline accepting any assistance on the part of foreign nations.

Under the circumstances, Captain Febriger and myself determined to remain passive observers, feeling that you understood the extent of your obligations under the treaty, and that you had made up your mind to discharge them with celerity and honor. Both Captain Febriger and myself fully realized that from that day we could not take any steps in advance of you, without virtually relieving you and your government of all responsibility with the United States, and interfering with the claim for indemnity which would be instituted for the families of such of the Rover's crew as were expected to be saved through your exclusive exertion, in case you would fail to fulfil your obligation in the manner it was expected that you would.

On the day previous to my leaving Taiwaufoo, you reiterated your promises in the course of our last interview, and as we were to embark we received the communication of a despatch addressed to you by the prefect of Taiwaufoo, pressing you to lose no time in sending troops forward to the relief of the Rover's crew, and for the punishment of the murderers of those who had lost their lives by the hands of the savages.

You cannot claim that you then ignored the name of the locality where the Rover had been wrecked, for you named it in your despatch of the 3d moon, 15th day, 6th year, 19th April, 1867, Bed-head island. Neither did you ignore the bay where the Rover's crew had been murdered, for you inform me in the same despatch that it is named Ku-wa-suh-pi-suan by the natives.

On the 28th day, 3d moon, 6th year, 2d May, 1867, you notified me that your officers were waiting for your orders, having their first column ready to advance, and they intended to prove by their acts that the Chinese government entertains the kindest feelings for the eastern nations. But now their language is quite different. You communicate to me the following despatch from them:

TAIWAUFOO, *2d day, 5th moon, 6th year, 3d Jnne*, 1877.

We, Tin-Pan-Chew-Chang and Pen-Kiep, having examined the treaty, article XI and XIII, provide that whenever within the jurisdiction of the Emperor of China, either on shore or at sea, any who shall molest Americans, shall be punished by the civil and military authorities, on their hearing of the same, to the best of their ability; but as in the Rover's case the Americans were not murdered on Chinese territory, or on Chinese seas, but on a region occupied by the savages, relief cannot be asked for them under the treaty. Were it in our power to seize the murderers we would gladly do so, so that the Chinese might keep friendship with foreigners, but the savage country does not come within the limits of our jurisdiction, &c., &c., &c.

One would have supposed that you would have at once blamed your subordinates, yet you write me under the same date:

On receipt of the foregoing, I determined to communicate it to you, having already sent to you a former despatch received on the same subject. Our impression is that our subordinates have furnished us with a true statement of the case, and we believe those savages to be wild animals with whom any one would disdain to contend. A government as great and generous as yours will always despise such beings, &c., &c., &c.

In answer I will remark that negotiations have now lasted longer than they should have done, and that they have to be brought to a close by a fair understanding on both parts of what I feel it is my duty to ask under the treaty, and of what you hold to be at liberty to concede under your interpretation of the same.

In consequence, I beg to reaffirm what I have said or written to you at former times, that the United States, in this case, as in any other, insist upon a strict observance of the treaties, on the part of the Chinese; and relative to this, I may remark that on the 18th day, 3d moon, 6th year, 19th April, 1867, appearing to fully understand Captain Febriger and myself, you promised to afford prompt relief to the Rover's crew, and to punish the murderers of such of them that had lost their lives by the hands of the inhabitants of the southern portion of the island of Formosa; that two months have elapsed since, and that nothing has been done on your part towards keeping this most sacred engagement, having only discovered, at this late hour, and through your agents, that you were not expected, under the treaty, to carry out your promises, they having been made in ignorance of certain facts that you have since ascertained.

The government of the United States cannot accept such an issue, and in its name I protest emphatically against (pardon me the expression) this shifting way of settling this most important question, and its deplorable consequence, and I do now make all possible reserve for all claims for indemnity and reparation which may hereafter be brought forward in consequence thereof by my government against yours.

The question involved in the wreck of the Rover and the murder of her crew by the inhabitants of the southern end of Taiwan, a dependency of the Chinese empire, does not only affect American interests, but also the interests of every one of the western nations that are connected by trade with China, and whose ships ply between the Spanish, Dutch and English possessions, south, southeast and southwest from Formosa, the various parts of China on the coast south of Amoy and those on the north of it. Those vessels either following their natural or direct route or carried out of it by the winds, are apt to come to grief on or near the breakers where the Rover was lost, and of necessity must seek refuge in the bay south of Formosa island; for if they go to the east side of Taiwan they find an abrupt coast where even ordinary embarcation would not

be safe; and if they go further to the north on the western coast they must not stop until they reach Lee-Chew bay, which is, at the least, 15 miles distant. Are they always in a position to make this long run? The deposition of the last known survivor of the Rover's crew seems to show otherwise, the unfortunates, in this case, having landed at the southern bay, because they could go no further, being exhausted by fatigue, thirst, and hunger. So that nine times out of ten they must stop at the southern bay, which seems to have been opened by the Almighty as a natural refuge against the uncertainty of the elements. Hence humanity makes it a law to civilized nations to see that this part of Formosa is kept clear of any of the inhospitable hordes that infest it, and if your government does not do it, on the ground that it has no jurisdiction therein or is inadequate to the task, the foreign powers will have to take the case in hand. The United States would hear with regret that the western nations have come to such a conclusion, for they would disdain the acquisition of territory they would gain by it, and it would be the beginning of a policy of violence that might ultimately end by the dismemberment of the Chinese empire and its humiliation, based on the incompetency of its authorities to command the respect of its own subjects or to fulfil certain obligations imposed upon them by the laws of nations.

I can assure you that it is to the interest of the United States that you should be prosperous, united, powerful, and at peace with foreign nations, and among your own people, and we have no ambitious design to accomplish in regard to you; no desire to acquire any of your territory, having already too large a one of our own; and the greater and more rich you become, the more mutually beneficial will be the trade between the two countries. Your prosperity will be for the good of the United States, and whatever tends to impair it a loss.

Yet, and with all this, the United States form a great commercial nation, and they are this above all. They desire the extension of trade all over the world, and would certainly not sacrifice their interests to a blind friendship for China or any other nation, and if any foreign power, justified by the neglect or ill-will of the Chinese, should undertake the control of the southern part of the island of Formosa, and clear it from the hordes that have interfered with our trade for years past, we would not oppose it. And although we would not, in all probability, retain any portion of the territory acquired, we would see with satisfaction any step taken that would secure the interests that the Chinese government would have declared themselves unable to protect.

The southern end of the Formosa channel is a most important commercial thoroughfare and must be kept open at all hazards. Having given these assurances of our good wishes and furnished you with the outline of our policy, I will now endeavor to show you that under the existing laws of nations that part of Taiwan settled by what you call the savages is one for the maintenance of order over which foreign nations are justified in looking to the government of China.

The Formosa savages stand on the same footing with the Indians that yet inhabit a great portion of the United States. What can with truth be said of one under the law of nations can equally be said of the other.

For the sake of their own interests, the United States have insisted with foreign powers that our Indians should hold their existence as tribes at our exclusive will. Even if you never expected to interfere with your Formosa natives further than to keep out the agents of the foreign powers who might seduce them into foreign alliance, the result of which would be the absorption of the island of Formosa by the foreign ally, you should, for your best interest, imitate us in that respect. For if you admit that such territory has never been explored, you admit that it could be seized by the first power whose interest it would serve to take it, and that power would acquire as indisputable a right to its possession as the Spanish had to the new world, when they first discovered

it, or as you yourselves had to the island of Formosa when you first planted your colonies on its western shore.

So the view that the western nations take of the native tribes of Formosa is, that they should not be treated as independent by China nor regarded as owners of the soil they may respectively occupy; but that China has a right to that same soil because it can take possession at leisure.

In fact, this doctrine seems to have been adopted by your government, since the Chinese farmers on the western side of the island, as fast as they find themselves crowded in their settlements, keep advancing towards the eastern coast, sword in hand, driving the natives before them, and it is likely that they will continue to do so until they have absorbed the whole country from the Formosa channel to the eastern shore. And in this they only confirm *de facto* the righteousness of the law I have quoted above, and in virtue of which superior races have by degrees, since the beginning of the world, substituted their civilization for that of inferior ones.

The Chinese divide and parcel out the land of the natives in Formosa, and grant it to their subjects as they need it, exactly as if it had been vacant and unoccupied land. They do more; anticipating the occupation of the native territory by their subjects, they control, in some instances, by the most arbitrary rules, the trade of native products with the natives of the western shore. Camphor, one of the most important staples of the island, is produced on the territory occupied by the natives. No foreigner is allowed to export it freely, or to acquire it therein. One individual enjoys the exclusive right to carry on the traffic for the benefit of the Chinese government. (Letter of the Taotai of Formosa to the United States consul at Amoy, dated 15th day, 3d moon, 6th year, 19th April, 1867.) Any one interfering with the rights of the monopolist is put to death.

So the Chinese government have even gone further with the natives of Formosa than the United States have gone with the Indians, and *de facto*, in the most flagrant manner, have for the last two hundred years insisted upon having supreme power and dominion over the territory therein.

If such is the case, it appears to be too forcibly and clearly established to admit of dispute that the savage tribes of Formosa are subject to the authority of China; and when the country occupied by the natives is not within the limits of the various Chinese magistrates, China can and should punish any offence committed therein, no matter whether the offender be a Chinese or a native, and it is not the duty of the foreign treaty powers to punish such offenders; for if the native territory is not Chinese in population, it is Chinese in fact, the Chinese population of Taiwan having a sort of pre-emption claim on it, which they enforce every day when they consider fit and advisable. Hence the last argument of your honor's letter against mixing yourself in the "Rover's" case, on the ground that you have no jurisdiction over that part of the Formosa, falls to the ground.

I could add to this many facts that would sustain an opinion expressed by me in my despatch to your honor, dated 28th day, 4th moon, 6th year, (30th May, 1867,) that many of the tribes living on the southern coast of Formosa, alleged to be savage, are only half-caste, and connected with the Chinese population of the western coast and of Swatow by trade or marriage, but it would uselessly add to this very long despatch and I shall come to a close.

Sincerely hoping that this communication will tend to reform your judgment of many points of vital importance both to China and the United States,

I have the honor to be, sir, your obedient servant,

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE,

United States Consul for Amoy and Dependencies.

The GENERAL and TAOTAI *of Formosa.*

No. 19.

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward.

No. 24.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES,
Amoy, July 5, 1867.

SIR: Referring to my despatches Nos. 17, 19, 21, 22, and 23, relating to the wreck of the American bark Rover, I have the honor to hand you, under this cover, enclosure No. 1, being an extract from a letter just received from Taikao, Formosa, from Mr. John Ross, residing there.

I have the honor to be, sir, your obedient servant,

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Hon. WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State, Washington, D. C.

Extract of a letter from Formosa, written by Mr. John Ross, dated June 17, 1867.

* * * * * * * *

Mr. Horn, a carpenter, came on the coast with a lorcha, which was smashed all to pieces the other day, the Chinese stealing everything. It was Mr. Horn's intention to go and see after the crew of the bark Rover.

On the 12th instant two American men-of-war arrived here, the Hartford and Wyoming. They left here the same evening for the place where the crew of the bark Rover are supposed to have been murdered. On the morning of the 13th they landed 200 men and followed the natives about eight miles into the interior, when they all sat down to rest, having about 20 men struck down by sunstroke, the sun being very hot at the time. While sitting down, two or three of the officers advanced a little. Then came a volley of rifles from the bush, killing Lieutenant Commander McKenzie. Poor fellow! he staggered back, and cried—"Doctor! doctor!" and fell to rise no more.

The admiral seeing there was no chance of doing anything, the natives being concealed in the bush, resolved that they should return to their ships. They arrived off Taitao on the 14th, and the funeral took place at five o'clock that afternoon. I attended, and a solemn sight it was to behold. Upwards of three hundred people were there, the drum playing the dead march to the grave. I was standing close to the admiral when they were filling the grave, and the old gentleman had to stand aside, being so much affected at the loss of one who was so much beloved and respected by all who knew him. They sailed the same evening for Shanghai. The admiral is determined to return again with re-enforcements at some future period.

JOHN ROSS.

UNITED STATES CONSULATE AT AMOY,
July 5, 1867.

A true copy of the original copy on file at this office.

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

No. 20.

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward.

No. 34.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,
Amoy, China, July 30, 1867.

SIR: Referring to my despatches Nos. 7, 19, 21, 22, 23, 24, relating to the wreck of the American bark Rover, I have now the honor to hand you, under this cover, enclosure No. 1, being the translation of a despatch just received from the viceroy of the Fohkien province, and which is an answer to my communication to his excellency of the copy of my despatch No. 72 to the general and Taotai of Formosa, already referred to you. (Enclosure No. 1

with my despatch No. 23.) Enclosure No. 2 is the copy of my despatch No. 3 to Rear-Admiral H. H. Bell, commanding the United States Asiatic squadron. In it I briefly show to the admiral the probability of a prompt action on the part of the Chinese authorities, and I ask him to lend me his support should my presence in Formosa be required.

I have the honor to be, sir, very respectfully, your obedient servant,

CHAS. W LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Hon. WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State, Washington, D. C.

TUNG CHI, *6th year, 6th moon, 24th day.*

On the 17th of this 6th month I received your communication, stating that a vessel of your nation had been wrecked on the southern part of Formosa, and the crew murdered by the savages, and that you had seen the General Taotai and prefect of Formosa, and had requested them to attend to the matter, and that they had promised verbally and by special communications to attend to it, and that on the 2d day of the 5th moon of the present year you had received from them a communication in which they refused to attend to the affair, and that this case being one of great importance to both nations, it was necessary to request me to examine into its merits and interpose my authority.

I have received from you a copy of your correspondence with the authorities at Formosa.

You personally had an interview with us on the subject, and the authorities at Formosa had informed us that they would give their immediate attention to the matter. Afterwards, on the 23d day of the 5th moon, the General and Taotai of Formosa advised us that the distance from Liung Kiau to Kui chai Cuh is several tens of le, (Chinese miles;) that jungle and forest were dense and dangerous, and that the savages skulked in the bushes or in caves; and inasmuch as the place occupied by the savages is not marked on the maps of China, the soldiers are unable to proceed there, and the object in view is a very difficult one to accomplish.

Now, with reference to the plundering and murdering, although it is done by savages, who are not reckoned as Chinese, and although it may not be easy to seize them, still it must be done. It must not be said that the country is not ours, and, therefore, the matter be neglected.

Already has an order been despatched with haste compelling the authorities of Formosa to send soldiers and to order the civil and military authorities to seize on the proper opportunities to properly conduct the case in a way that will enable them to rescue the survivors, and to recover the bodies of the dead, to punish the murderers according to law, and to maintain terms of friendship among nations.

VICEROY.
Lieut. Gov. LEI.

The UNITED STATES CONSUL of Amoy, China.

UNITED STATES CONSULATE,
Amoy, July 30, 1867.

A true copy of the origiual on file in this office.

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

No. 3.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES,
Amoy, China, July 30, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your despatch, dated Shanghai, July 16, 1867, and I am much obliged to you for the valuable views of the Rover's case you give me therein.

I have taken proper steps to call the attention of the viceroy of the Fohkien province to such of them as would interest him at the present time.

I now beg to submit the answer received (enclosure No. 1) from the viceroy of the Fohkien province to a communication made to him on the 20th instant, together with a copy of my despatch No. 72 to the General and Taotai of Taiwan enclosed to you in my despatch No. 2, of June 30, 1867.

Baron de Meileus, who on the occasion has acted as my interpreter and intermedium, had been requested to call the attention of the viceroy to three points: 1. The necessity of the Chinese authorities taking immediate steps. 2. Their obligation to enable me to ascertain that such steps were taken. 3. The great importance of locating a military settlement at the end of the island of Formosa, so as to keep it clear from the savages infesting it. On the 27th instant, Baron de Meileus advised me that the viceroy had forwarded orders by a special steamer to the authorities at Taiwan to organize forthwith an expedition against the savages therein; that both the governor and general of the island would be responsible for the success of the operations; that in case they should fail they would be dismissed; that I had been invested to proceed to Formosa to receive by the hands of the Chinese the unfortunate survivors, if any, of the Rover's crew, and the bodies of those that have been killed. Of course, it is expressly understood that I am going there as a mere spectator, and that I have no jurisdiction or command over the Chinese forces, but I am expected to satisfy myself that they do what is required. The viceroy will write me by the Jesse to invite me to proceed to Formosa for that object.

Nothing definite has yet been settled as to the third point, but I am convinced it can be settled as the two first ones. If on the sixth proximo it is not carried I shall call in person upon the viceroy, and I greatly hope to succeed. The Tailar General has never failed yet to support me, and I depend a great deal upon him for success. Of course the Baron de Meileus in the case has been of material importance, and without him I believe that I would have failed.

Under these circumstances, I have asked Captain Febriger, now in Amoy, whether he would feel authorized to afford me a passage to Formosa, in case I would proceed there in two or three weeks for the purpose I have explained above; or if he would have to wait for orders from you. His answer was that he had no authority to go to Formosa, but would have to refer the matter to you. Having thus conferred with Captain Febriger on the subject, it has been agreed between us that I should write you directly on the subject.

I beg to remark, sir, that in this case I have not gone beyond the limits of my power, and that in simply persuading the Chinese authorities I have only carried out the instructions received from the United States minister at Pekin. Indeed, the answer he sent to my despatch, No. 3, of April 1, asking for instructions, was most explicit. (Enclosure No. 2.)

Since I have carefully communicated to him my correspondence on the subject, and he has not once censured the course I have taken, and truly believing that it would be of great importance for us to obtain now from the Chinese government a redress which every one I have seen yet encourages me to seek, and which, if we do obtain, will greatly add to the prestige of our flag in the east, I have used every effort to succeed; and now that I firmly believe that I am almost certain of doing so, I come to beg you to lend me your support by affording me the means of going to Formosa in the manner I have applied for to Captain Febriger.

In closing this I respectfully beg to state that by the time your answer to this despatch comes to hand it will be about time for me to leave for Formosa, and my impression is that my presence will be required there for about six weeks.

I have the honor to be, sir, with great respect, your obedient servant,

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Rear-Admiral H. H. BELL,
Com'ding U. S. Asiatic Squadron, Shanghai, China.

No. 21.

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward.

No. 35.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,
Amoy, China, September 4, 1867.

SIR: I beg to hand you, under this cover, enclosures No. 1, 2, 3, 4, being copies of my correspondence with his excellency the minister of the United States at the court at Peking, relating to the Rover's case. Also with Rear-Admiral H. H. Bell, on the same.

I have the honor to be, sir, very respectfully, your obedient servant,

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Hon WILLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State, Washington, D. C.

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Burlingame.

No. 16.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES,
Amoy, August 29, 1867.

SIR: Referring to my despatches Nos. 3, 7, 9, 13, 14, relating to the wreck of the American bark Rover, I have now the honor to hand you under this cover three enclosures, viz:

No. 1, being despatch No. 95, to his excellency the viceroy of the Fohkien province, urging his excellency to order the immediate occupation of the southern bay by the Chinese forces.

No. 2, being a despatch from the viceroy in answer to my No. 95 bis., and giving me the assurance that the question of the occupation of the southern bay by the Chinese forces shall be settled amicably after the expedition has taken place, and that on receipt of the reports of the authorities of Formosa, the Emperor would be informed of the measures taken.

No. 3, being an answer from the viceroy to my despatch No 96, asking for a more clear statement of the measures taken by him for the occupation of the southern bay of Formosa. In this communication the viceroy says:

Relating to the military occupation of the southern bay I have to inform you that I have already named the commanding officer of the force of occupation, Ke-Con-K-Chang-Lu, and have ordered him to escort you to Formosa. As to what relates to the affair of the Rover in itself the most severe orders have been given that it be settled without delay, and your visit to Taiwanfoo, made agreeably with us, is a new proof given to you that there shall be no delay in the execution of my orders.

On the following day, the 19th instant, Baron de Meritens informed me that he had received the order to charter a steamer to convey me to Formosa, but not judging that it would be proper for me to increase, without necessity, the

expenses of the Chinese government in this case, I have agreed to take the viceroy's small steamer the Volunteer.

I left Foo Chow on the 24th and arrived here on the 25th.

To-day, the 29th, I received a note from Baron de Meritens stating that on the 26th instant a convoy of 300 soldiers were armed and equipped, and four brass pieces, two of four and two of nine, had been despatched to Formosa, with a suitable quantity of ammunition, by the viceroy, and that the Volunteer, being now repaired and painted, would be in Amoy for my exclusive service on the 4th of September in the morning.

The Chinese admiral is reported to have left this port yesterday for Formosa.

Mr. White, commissioner of customs in Tukao, reports that the bodies of the captain of the Rover and his wife have been recovered, with many effects of their property.

I receive this instant a despatch from Admiral Bell, (enclosure No. 4.) I have the honor to submit to your excellency my answer to him, (enclosure No. 5.)

I have the honor to be, sir, very respectfully, your obedient servant,

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

His Excellency ANSON BURLINGAME,
United States Minister at Peking.

[Sub-enclosure A.]

Copy of a despatch addressed by the United States consul at Amoy to the Viceroy of the Fohkien Provinces, dated August 6, 1867.

I have the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your despatch relating to the positive orders given to the authorities of Formosa to settle at once and amicably the affair of the Rover. I have seen, with satisfaction, in the despatch referred to above, that your excellency has given orders to the governor and the general commanding at Formosa to occupy the southern bay, and to punish the guilty parties; and, also, that your excellency has rendered an account to the Emperor of your determination to send at once to Formosa the General F. Seng, and the Prefect Wang-Chay, to aid the authorities of the island in executing their orders, chiefly as to what relates to the delivery, in my hands, of the remains of those who have been murdered at the time of the wreck, and the immediate rescue of those who are yet alive.

Although I take into full consideration the promptitude with which your excellency has acted, I am compelled to call the attention of your excellency to a very serious point, viz: the absolute necessity of taking energetic measures to prevent the recurrence of such atrocities in the future. In my opinion such measures should consist of the permanent military occupation of the southern bay by a force of five or six hundred men, and the establishment of a civil authority at Liang-Kian bay, a series of measures that would encourage the Chinese population of the western coast to settle on that rich country. and to improve it, and it would offer a sure guarantee to the merchant ships that might hereafter be wrecked on that coast, that they would not be captured and plundered and their crew murdered. All parties interested would feel themselves equally satisfied in hearing that such an arrangement had been come to, and your excellency would have rendered a striking service to the Chinese government which the Emperor is not likely to overlook.

As for one I must add that his excellency, the ambassador and minister plenipotentiary of the United States at the court of Peking, would find himself satisfied should both points defined above be settled in conformity with my wishes; and that this arrangement would put an end to the case of the Rover, still open.

The instructions I have received from his excellency, the ambassador of the United States at Peking, require that I should go to Taiwanfoo to receive the remains of such of my countrymen who have been murdered and those who have been spared. My first thought was to proceed to Taiwanfoo in an American man-of-war, but your excellency having expressed the desire that the United States gunboat postpone visiting, for the present, the port of Liang-Kian, for fear that the national susceptibilities of the Chinese be touched, I haste to say, that considering the friendly relations now existing between both countries, and with a view to maintain and if possible extend such relations, I am ready to proceed to Formosa in one of your excellency's steamers. If the steamer Le Chang Tching does not arrive in a few days at Foo-Chow, your excellency might borrow the custom's schooner Vindex, and the commissioner would certainly agree to any such arrangement. In this case your excellency would have merely to hand to the undersigned an official despatch for the governor of Formosa, relating to the occupation of the southern bay, and to order one of your excellency's officers to escort me to see that your excellency's orders are carried into effect, and to make an amicable settlement of this important affair certain.

[Sub-enclosure B.]

Translation of a letter from the viceroy of the Fohkien Provinces to General LeGendre, United States consul at Amoy, dated August 7, 1867.

In answer to your despatch, and to your private note; first, relating to the establishment of a permanent military occupation of the southern bay, as shown on the map annexed to your private note, and with a view to prevent any new complication on the part of the savages; second, to the restitution of the remains of such of the crew of the Rover who have been murdered there; and third, to the steamer that would convey you to Formosa, I have the honor to inform you that I have already communicated to the throne the orders sent by me to the authorities at Formosa, and my special despatch there to settle at once, and in conformity with justice, all that relates to the wreck of the Rover, and you may rest assured that I shall not allow any delay in the settlement of this affair.

As to what relates to the military occupation of the bay near Liang Kiow, this question shall be solved amicably after the expedition has taken place, and on receipt of the report of the authorities at Formosa relating thereto, I will inform the Emperor of the measures I have taken.

As to borrowing the Vindex from the commissioner of customs to transport you to Formosa, there is no difficulty in it, and the question of expense is of small importance under such circumstances.

This despatch is sent to you for your information.

Translation of a letter addressed by the viceroy of the Fohkien Provinces to the United States consul at Amoy, August 18, 1867.

The viceroy to General LeGendre, United States consul:

In answer to your letter to me, dated August 16, relating to the Formosa affair, and by which you ask that positive orders embodied in the official despatch sent to the government of Formosa and to the prefect of Taiwanfoo, relating to the military occupation of the southern bay, I have to inform you that I have already named the commanding officer of the force of occupation, Kicon Fehoung Lei, and have ordered him to escort you to Formosa. As to handing to you the official despatch addressed to the governor of Formosa, so

that you may hand it to him personally, you will understand that I cannot do so under the present circumstances.

The securities claimed for the future must be discussed at the same time with the other questions, and on receipt of the report of the governor of Formosa, and of the prefect of Taiwanfoo, showing me that all has been settled, I will address a memorial to the throne.

As to what relates to the affair of the Rover in itself, the most severe orders have been given that it be settled without delay, and your visit to Taiwanfoo, made agreeably with us, is a new proof given to you that there shall be no delay in the execution of my orders.

As to the steamer that will convey you to Formosa, I have given orders to the members of the board of trade to make arrangements with the commissioner of customs for this port.

To-morrow, at 11 a. m., I will thank you to call on me with the commissioner of customs, when we will discuss the details of this affair.

[Enclosure No. 2.]

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Burlingame.

No. 17.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,
Amoy, China, September 4, 1867.

SIR: Referring to my despatch No. 16, dated August 29, 1867, I beg to state that I have this day left for Formosa by the Chinese government steamer Volunteer, to receive the remains of the unfortunates who were murdered by the natives at the time the Rover was wrecked, and to witness the military occupation of the southern part of the island of Formosa by the Chinese force.

I have, &c.,

CHARLES LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

His Excellency Hon. ANSON BURLINGAME,
&c., &c., &c., Peking.

[Enclosure No. 3.]

Admiral Bell to Mr. LeGendre.

UNITED STATES FLAG-SHIP HARTFORD,
Shanghai, August 20, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor to acknowledge the reception of your communication, dated Amoy, China, July 30, 1867, enclosing a despatch received by you from the viceroy of the Fohkien province; also an extract from a despatch received from the United States minister at Peking.

I regret that I cannot spare a vessel at this time to go to Formosa, as some of them are about returning to the United States.

It would give me much pleasure to hear of the colonizing of the south bay, but the evident indisposition of the Taotai of Taiwan indicates that the commands of the viceroy of Fohkien will not avail much towards that object at present.

I have the honor to be, sir, very respectfully,

H. H. BELL,
Rear-Admiral, Commanding U. S. Asiatic Squadron.

General C. W. LEGENDRE,
United States Consul, Amoy.

[Enclosure No. 4.]

Mr. LeGendre to Rear-Admiral Bell.

CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES,
Amoy, August 29, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your despatch of the 20th August, 1867, conveying me the expression of your regrets at being unable to spare a vessel at this time to go to Formosa, and expressing your desire to see the south bay of the island colonized.

In answer I would state that the viceroy has placed a steamer at my exclusive order to proceed to Formosa, there to receive the remains of our countrymen, and witness the military occupation of the bay by the Chinese forces. I have accepted the offer of his excellency, and shall leave on the 4th of September.

I beg to be allowed to inform you of the result of my trip to Formosa on my return.

I have the honor to be, sir, &c., &c.,

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Admiral H. H. BELL,
Commanding U. S. Asiatic Squadron, Shanghai, China.

No. 22.

Mr. F. W. Seward to Mr. LeGendre.

No. 28.] DEPARTMENT OF STATE,
Washington, September 13, 1867.

SIR: Your despatches Nos. 19, 20, 21 and 22, have been received.

The account you give of your proceedings in the matter of the murder of the crew of the American bark Rover, at the island of Formosa, has been read with interest, and your action is approved and your diligence commended.

Proper acknowledgments of the services of Commodore Broad, of her Britannic Majesty's navy, will be made.

I am, sir, your obedient servant,

F. W. SEWARD,
Assistant Secretary.

CHARLES W. LEGENDRE, Esq.,
United States Consul, Amoy.

No. 23.

Mr. F. W. Seward to Mr. LeGendre.

No. 22.] DEPARTMENT OF STATE,
Washington, September 24, 1867.

SIR: Your interesting despatches Nos. 23 and 24, relating to the wreck of the bark Rover and the murder of the officers and crew on the island of Formosa, have been received, and your proceedings are approved.

The department will await with solicitude the views of our minister in China, to whom you say you have given a copy of your despatch No. 23.

You will please accept thanks for your attention in gathering and communicating such interesting facts in regard to the expedition of the admiral and the painful sacrifice of the life of Commander Mackenzie.

I am, sir, your obedient servant,

F. W. SEWARD,
Acting Secretary.

CHARLES W. LEGENDRE, Esq.,
United States Consul, Amoy.

No. 24.

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Seward.

No. 41.] CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,
Amoy, November 21, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor to hand you copy of despatch No. 18 to the United States minister at Peking, enclosure No. 1, (Rover's case.)

I also transmit to you a copy of an inquest made at this consulate upon the remains of the late Mrs. Hunt, enclosure No. 2.

I have honor to be, sir, very respectfully, your obedient servant,

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Hon. WILLLIAM H. SEWARD,
Secretary of State, &c., &c., &c.

[Enclosure No. 1.]

Mr. LeGendre to Mr. Burlingame.

CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,
Amoy, November 8, 1867.

SIR: Referring to my despatch No. 17, I have the honor to state that, on the 3d of September last, the steamship Volunteer, in the viceroy's service, anchored at Amoy, and the next morning the mandarin commanding the vessel called at the consulate, with an interpreter, designated by the viceroy to accompany me during the expedition. It was to inform me that the steamer was placed at my order, (enclosure No. 1.) I notified that I would be in readiness to leave the same day in the afternoon.

Yet the arrival of the Volunteer having been expected for some days, and her destination being known, some excitement was caused at Amoy, and during the day I noticed an unusual agitation at the British consulate, the bearing of which I could not then well apprehend, but which has since appeared to be not entirely foreign to the difficulties I had to encounter. Many of the British, under the most tempting pretexts, offered to accompany me. But I declined all applications, save that of a French travelling gentleman, Mr. Y. Bernard, who, from his knowledge from Formosa and the Chinese, was qualified to act as my secretary, with a devotion I had learned at other times not to doubt of.

At 5 p. m., on my way to the vessel, I met the interpreter and the mandarin in charge of the Volunteer, showing all appearance of great haste. They said that a despatch from the viceroy at Foochow ordered them to take me simply and directly to Tackao; and further, that the Chinese admiral at Amoy wished to accompany me, and therefore the departure of the steamer would be postponed till the next day at 12 a. m. This circumstance, which I had not been called

to foresee during the official interview of the morning, led me to suspect some hostile designs, and I hastened to embark.

Arrived on board, I communicated to the mandarin the despatch of the viceroy, (enclosure No. 1,) in which no mention was made of my departure for Formosa, being dependent on the pleasure of an admiral or any other official. The steamer was placed at my order, not to Tackao or any other specified port, but to Formosa. Hence I insisted on starting at once, and for Taiwanfoo, where of necessity I had to go first. Yet night had come on, and yielding to the representations of the mate, that there would be some danger in leaving the port of Amoy that same evening, I agreed to leave the next morning at daylight.

On the 5th, at 6 a. m., we went to sea, hoisting the United States flag at the mast-head. On the morning of the 6th we were in Taiwanfoo. The authorities, notified of my coming, sent at once an officer with the means of transportation, to proceed with the usual ceremonies to the house prepared for me. I had just called when the prefect called, wishing to make me the first visit. We agreed to call the next morning upon the Taotai.

I received from the first civil officers in the place the most flattering welcome. There had gathered the Taotai (civil,) the Chintai, (general commanding in chief.) The Chintai, second in command, all red buttons of the second class, the prefects, and the sub-prefects. I immediately came to the object of my visit, and it was, indeed, with admirable unanimity that the Chinese officials made the most handsome promises in regard to the measures which, in your name, I had required them to take, and which had been ordered in unequivocal terms by his excellency the viceroy. The first wing (?) of the army had left in advance of me, and prompt and entire satisfaction should be made to my demands. I then answered, that fully satisfied with their readiness to comply with the just demands of your excellency, I had made up my mind to witness, in person, all the details of the expedition which promised so well, and begged them that no time might be lost in carrying them out.

The effect of my declaration was soon noticed, first in the faces, and then in the language of the officers. This expedition, which, an hour ago, they announced as being so prompt to move, of necessity must suffer many delays from the nature of the movement itself, as well as of the localities through which we must pass. Of course a portion of the army had already left, but the last corps (?) was not ready to follow. The Chintai in command had yet a great deal of business to attend to before he could leave Taiwanfoo. Moreover, the roads were rocky and almost impracticable in a country where Chinese authority had not been well established. We could not advance but with excessive caution. There would be danger also to the person of the consul, and they could but decline such a responsibility.

I came at once to the conclusion that the mandarins had at one time hoped they could elude the order of the viceroy, so onerous to the purse of the Taotai, and that the difficulty could be removed by means of a comedy played at a distance and among themselves, without troublesome witnesses, in which a few head of savages sent to Foochow, with great display, would be an easy and less expensive denoument. I therefore insisted, relieving the Chintai of any responsibility for my personal safety, and assuring them that I had not come to Formosa merely to hear what they had to say, but I had come to Formosa to judge for myself, without regard to fatigues, or to the measures taken to execute the orders of the viceroy. In vain did the Taotai attempt a diversion by inviting us to partake of a collation just made ready. I refused to adjourn the discussion even for an hour, and declared my determination to put back forthwith for Foochow. Hearing this, the Taotai tried a few words of explanation, and the Chintai, (the ranking officer on the island,) whose determination, unusual culture and high mind had led him to perceive, in advance of the rest, that they had to decide either in the affirmative or the negative, settled the difficulty by

taking upon himself to say that we would leave within three days. We all gathered around the tables, and not another word was uttered as to the object which had brought me to Formosa. On my return home I received the visit of the various mandarins, and in the evening the six highest authorities of the island sent me a collective invitation to dinner at the prefect's. On the evening of the 8th we were all at the prefect's, where a most brilliant reception was tendered us.

As agreed, on the morning of the 10th we left Taiwanfoo, occupying the centre of the column between Chintai Lew and Chintai Chin. The prefect had most liberally provided transportation for myself, Mr. Bernard, the interpreter, and our two servants, as well as our luggage and provisions. Finally, an escort of light men preceded me, and were to remain with me during my stay in Formosa. Leaving Taiwanfoo we followed a very narrow road, yet practicable for chairs carried by skilled bearers. In the evening we made our first halt at Anthon-Kien. (Enclosure, map.) The next day at dusk we reached Pitan, a large town of 70,000 inhabitants. Here there was a review of the troops by Chintai Lew. But there being no appearance of advance, I called on the Chintai for explanation. His excuse was that on leaving Taiwanfoo he had been furnished by the Taotai with only the insufficient sum of $5,000; but he promised to make up the deficiency himself, in case the Taotai delayed much longer. He begged me to believe that he was most anxious to execute the orders of the viceroy, and said that I should hold the Taotai, and not him, responsible for any delay. Thus I had to note once more the wisdom of the viceroy in intrusting the command of the expedition to a man of such ability and so ambitious of distinction. I believe that he thoroughly understood that day that the orders of the viceroy had to be executed under my eyes, and with all possible celerity. He agreed to leave on any event on the 14th.

On the morning of the 14th the Taotai had not been heard from. We left, however, advancing towards Tong-Kong (map) by a narrow road, crossing in our way four streams on light bamboo rafts. At dusk we were only separated from the village by a narrow bay, which we crossed on bamboo rafts. Tong-Kong is a small port of difficult access, but secure for junks. The main products are rice and sugar cane. At this town Chinese authority practically ceases. Here, however, taxes are paid more or less regularly. We spent the night in a sugar refinery, and left at daylight for Panglian, (map,) which we reached the same night. Panglian extends along the shore at the summit of an arc of a circle forming a bay, and is, therefore, too open to be secure. The products are rice and peanuts. Women pound the rice and till the fields, while the men are entirely taken up with fishing. To the east, at a cannon-shot from the sea, rise abruptly from the valley high mountains, the exclusive domain of the aborigines, who receive from the Chinese (or half caste) population a certain share of their crops as a royalty for the lands they have rented to them forever. There, for the first time, we notice that none leave the village without being armed.

We were still far from our destination, and at the foot of high hills occupied by savages. There were no roads, but only hunters' paths, and these never yet traversed either by Chinese or Europeans. Nor on account of the monsoon was it practicable to reach the southern bay by sea, and we were, therefore, by force of circumstances, apparently condemned to a rest, the end of which no one could foresee. Fortunately, on the next day the Chintai received 8,000 taels from the Taotai, and he was most anxious to advance. I thought the circumstance favorable to hazard my advice, a thing which until then I had declined to do, being anxious to avoid taking any part in the management of the expedition. I intimated that it would not be impossible to cut a road over the mountains. We had to do it at intervals, over a line some 40 or 50 miles long, and if there was no interference on the part of the aborigines with

whom we were not at war, the work might be accomplished in four or five days. The Chintai seized my idea at once, perceiving how he would thus be extricated from his difficult position. Moreover the result of opening such a way would be to establish a communication between the northern and southern parts of the island. Such communication, prompt and sure, would withdraw these aborigines from their isolation, and open the way for the establishment of Chinese rule over them. The Bootan tribes, whose territory we were to pass through, made no opposition, and the work commenced.

A fortunate diversion in our monotonous stay at Panglian occurred on the arrival of two young Englishmen, Messrs. Pickering and Holmes. The former (in charge of the house of Elles & Co., in Taiwanfoo) I had met six months before in my visit in the United States steamer Ashuelot. Knowing him to be versed in the various dialects of the aborigines, I had begged him in the name of humanity to proceed to the South Point, with a view to rescue if possible the Rover's crew, and he has promised to make the attempt. He had accompanied Admiral Bell in his expedition to the southern bay. They were now returning from the southern bay, where they had gone for the purpose of recovering the remains of the lamented Mrs. Hunt, and of rescuing eight Bashee islanders who had been cast on the southeast shore, and who, after losing two of their number by the hands of the savages, had been reduced to slavery. They had expended all their funds furnished by the English consul, Mr. Carrol, from the moneys appropriated to this humane object by his government, $350, and was reduced to their last resources. Having done the best I could for the poor Bashees, I sent them to Chintai Lew, who supplied them and gave them a guide to Tackao. Besides, at my request, he ordered the money advanced by Mr. Carrol to be refunded to him, (enclosure No. 2.) As to Mr. Pickering, who had succeeded both in the rescue of the Bashees and in recovering the remains of Mrs. Hunt, I did not hesitate to accept his kind offer to remain with me. From his knowledge of the island and people he was enabled to render me valuable services.

The road across the mountains being finished, we left Panglian at noon on the 22d. The same day, having crossed without opposition a high range of hills, we came to Chi-Tong-Kian, a half-caste mixed village on the sea-shore. We went again across another range, arriving at dark at Tong-Kan, where we spent the night. We had gone half of our way without meeting other difficulties than such as arose from the nature of the localities. All concurred in predicting opposition from the savages on the next day, but nothing of the kind happened—thanks, probably, to the care the Chintai had taken to occupy the doubtful passes by detachments of his troops—and the same evening we safely reached Liang-Kian.

Liang-Kian is situated at the far point of the curve forming the bay of that name. The port is everything but secure, for on the evening of our arrival we saw the wreck of four junks of the Chintai's flotilla. There are about 1,500 inhabitants, mostly engaged in the culture of pea-nuts, rice, sweet potatoes, a little sugar cane, and also in fishing. Some, however, trade with the aborigines.

To this place the Chintai had sent in advance a mandarin of the Red Button, 3d class, to prepare the population and explain the object of the expedition. Following the sea towards the south for one half hour, Taulian is reached. It is another small port where the Chinese authority is but little respected. There the anchorage for junks is excellent at the mouth of a small river, and there in fact was the rendezvous of the flotilla carrying the heavy artillery and munitions of our small corps of operations. On the left, in the plain, near the mountains, at one hour from Tangtian lies Poliac, a village settled by a race of Hak-Kas, (old Cantonese,) crossed with the aborigines. They consider themselves to be the subjects of Tooke-took, the chief of the 18 tribes of the aborigines occupying the southern end of the island, as well as of the Emperor

of China. Poliac is the entrepot of the aborigines. There they find gunpowder and shot; there are manufactured their guns, excellent arms, much superior to those used by the Chinese soldiers. Further yet, coming back to the sea, that is to say, to the right and five hours march from Tanlian and Poliac, and in the heart itself of the mountains, nearly at the centre of the southern bay, may be found the half-caste village (Fookien Chinese crossed by aborigines) Tossu-Pond, where no mandarin has ever penetrated. China ends there.

The space bounded by a line going east and south from Poliac to the eastern and southern shore of the island is occupied by the Hwan tribes, 18 in all—numbering 955 warriors, and 1,300 women and children—and forming a confederation under Tooke-took of the Walassak tribe. Among them the most prominent are Bootan, Cash-li, Cu-su-coot, Pat-ye-on, Chew-a-keak, Dik-se-ah, Ba-ah, Tellosok, Bany-Tsoot, Sa-vo-ree, Pepo, Kou-tang, Ling-nuan, Kooluts. There is another tribe, called Amian, kept as slaves or servants to the other tribes.

Chintai Lew had an excellent base of operations at Liang-Kian, having the sea on the right, and holding the new line of communication with Taiwanfoo. He had Tanlian in his hand. A few pieces of artillery and a small force enabled him to hold Poliac, and his army could advance by a good wide road in the direction of the Point, and fall on the Kooluts from the summit of their mountains and drive them into the sea without possible escape. For this operation it is well that the Chintai did not require a large force of regulars; for of the 1,000 men promised, only 500 had been furnished, and these, although armed with good European rifles, were inadequate to the task before them. On my remarking this to the Chintai, he informed me that he had enrolled 1,500 of the country militia, who had been trained in the school of adventure in their fights with the savages. I could not but fear that men called away at the time of rice harvest would not have much ardor in their work, and there was the risk that when they came to action they might after all be better affected towards the savages, from whose friendship they could derive *gain*, than toward the Chinese authority, that could only make *promises*. Whatever might have been the case, it is certain that these considerations had an effect on future operations.

Before reaching Liang-Kian, and while preparing for his advance, Chintai had issued a proclamation, announcing the object of his mission, viz: the destruction of the Kooluts, for the murder of the crew of the American bark Rover, thus rectifying the first proclamation, in which the Rover, in consequence of written information received from Mr. Carrol, the British consul at Taikas, was qualified as a *British* bark. This proclamation, backed by the unprecedented military display, had deeply impressed the half-caste population, and the effect had also extended to the savages, so that the latter, doubtless in consequence of the terror inspired by the presence of the troops, and also being solicited thereto by their Chinese friends, who feared the consequences of war, sent on the day of our arrival at Liang-Kian a Chinese and half-caste deputation to convey the assurance of their regret and deep repentance for the murder of the Rover's crew, and to promise in their name that the like should never occur again, if the Chintai would only agree to make peace. For this the Chinese professed their willingness to become sureties. This disposition on their part having been announced to me by Mr. Pickering, previously to being communicated to me by the Chintai, I frankly said to him that I considered it quite in accordance with the generous policy of the United States to sacrifice a vain revenge, which might be hereafter used as a pretext for retaliation, to the incomparable advantage we would gain in securing against the recurrence of crimes such as we had come to punish; still that I did not wish to force upon them a solution which might be contrary to their instructions, and, consequently,

I would decline lending my hand unto it, unless they were quite disposed to accept of it. Having received the assurance that such was the case, after many and prolonged interviews, I demanded the following: (enclosure No. 3.*)

1st. I must see Tooke-took and the chiefs of the 18 tribes, in order to receive in person their regrets and assurances for the future.

2d. The Chinese authorities must furnish me with the bond of the Chinese and half-castes from Liang-Kian to Tosse Pove.

3d. They must require from the savages the refunding of the expenses incurred by Mr. Pickering in recovering the body of Mrs. Hunt, and new efforts were to be made towards recovering any effects of Captain Hunt in the hand of the savages.

4th. Finally, a fortified observatory must be erected at the southern bay as a guarantee of imperial protection, at a place where it has hitherto been wanting.

We agreed to act on this basis, and the delegates undertook to arrange the contemplated interview at Poliac within three days. Yet the day preceding the proposed interview with the chiefs, before taking the responsibility of promising to forgive and forget, I thought it prudent to obtain in writing from the vice-roy's agent the acquiescence they had so willingly given verbally, and I wrote them a note to that effect, asking for a speedy reply. Ill-served, I doubt not, by my interpreter, who had agreed to hand the letter to the generals and explain it, I saw the day passing away, but no answer.

Yet Tooke-took, the 18 chiefs, and a numerous escort had arrived the same evening at Poliac, and sent me word that I was expected on the morrow. On the other hand the delay of the generals in answering my letter caused me to suspect some evil design on their part, and made it my duty to be the more cautious before passing my word to Tooke-took. I therefore notified them that I would not meet Tooke-took before receiving their answer; and such delay would probably ruin everything. It was all in vain. They gave me many specious excuses, but no answer. The next morning I requested Mr. Pickering to see Tooke-took and explain to him why I could not come. He found him in Poliac, attended by 600 warriors. But the desired answer from the generals had not been received, and the day advancing, Tooke-took, unable to find proper quarters at Poliac, or, perhaps, suspecting treachery on the part of the mandarins, or being tired of waiting, concluded to leave.

Chintae Len, who by that time had come to the conclusion to answer my note, was visibly troubled at the disappearance of Tooke-took, and begged of me to let him arrange another interview with the chiefs. I consented, and three days afterwards was informed that Tooke-took would meet us at the volcano some four miles from the east coast of the island, *i. e.*, in the midst of savage territory. We left on the morning of the 10th of October without other escort than Mr. Bernard, Mr. Pickering, three interpreters, and our guide, and reached our destination at noon. I found Tooke-took surrounded by a number of chiefs and some 200 savages of both sexes. We sat on the ground without ceremony in the centre of the group. We were unarmed. They had their guns between their knees. All knew what had prevented me from meeting them before. So, without preamble, I began by asking them what could have led them to murder our countrymen. Tooke-took hastened to reply, that a long time ago white people had all but exterminated the Koolut tribe, leaving only three, who survived to hand down to their posterity the desire for revenge. Having no ships to pursue foreigners they had taken their revenge as best they could. I observed that in this way many innocent victims must have been killed. "I knew it," said he, "and am an enemy to the practice, and, therefore, sought to join you at Poliac to express my regrets." I then asked him what he intended doing in the future. His answer was, "If you come to make war we shall resist you, of

* Omitted in this despatch, but sent to Peeking.

course, and I cannot answer for the consequences. If, on the contrary, you desire peace, it shall be so forever." I told him I had come as a friend, and on hearing it he put his gun to one side.

I added that we were not unwilling to forget the past, but that in the future, far from murdering the unfortunate castaways, he should promise to care for them, and hand them over to the Chinese of Liang-Kian. He promised to do so. I added that in case a crew was sent ashore for fresh water or anything else, they should not be molested. This point he agreed to, and we settled upon a red flag (at the chief's request) as a sign through which ships would make known to him or his tribes a desire to land a party for friendly purposes, under the contract we had entered into that day.

I then hazarded the question of the fort; I wished it to be erected at the centre of the bay, where the unfortunate McKenzie met his fate. But Tooke-took refused. It would bring misfortune on his tribe. "Every one at his own place," said he; "if you place Chinese in our midst their bad faith will cause our people to rise in anger. Build your fort among the half-castes. They will not object to it, and it will satisfy us." I assented to his request, when, rising, he addressed me, saying, "We have said enough. Let us depart, and not spoil such a friendly interview by words that would make us enemies." All my efforts to retain him failed. The interview lasted three-quarters of an hour.

Tooke-took is a man of 50. His address is easy and his language most harmonious. His physiognomy is sympathetic, showing great strength of mind and indomitable energy. He is of a sanguine temperament, not of high stature—even small—but square shouldered and well built. His hair, which is gray, is shaved on the fore part of the head, in Chinese fashion, and he wears a small cue 12 or 15 inches long. But his costume is peculiar to his race, and distinct in all respects from the Chinese.

The same day, instead of returning to Liang-Kian, we went to the left across the territory of the savages and of the Lingman, directing our steps to the southwest part of the island, called Tossu-Pond, where I decided to locate the fort. This location is on a promontory one mile distant from a small half-caste village called Tossu-Pond. From it can be seen every part of the bay. We could distinctly see the roads followed by the expedition of Admiral Bell, and boldly projecting was the fatal rock, a gloomy mass of trachytes, near which fell McKenzie. Full of thoughts about this painful spot, we set out to return to Liang-Kian, to hurry on the erection of the fort and the writing of the bond to be given by the Chinese and half-caste population.

The establishment of a fort had often been the object of a serious controversy between Chintai Lew and myself, not that he would systematically oppose it—he had, on the contrary, acknowledged the advantages to the Chinese—but because of an obscure point in the viceroy's instructions. He did not feel authorized to erect it before he conferred with the Toochou or Peking authorities. I could scarcely subordinate my departure to such delay, and yet I wanted the fort. I wanted it because of its asserting the Chinese authority where it had been so long denied, for I considered that it would command respect from the Kooluls in case they happened to lose sight of their promises. Finally, and chiefly, because it would become a sure refuge for the too numerous victims of those stormy seas.

In short, I insisted, and we agreed at last that a temporary fort should be erected at a point selected by me, and that in it they would place two guns, a small force of regulars, and 100 militia. This provisional arrangement was to be converted into a permanent one as soon as the more explicit orders that I was asked to solicit should have reached Taiwanfoo. I declared myself satisfied, for I did not imagine that the viceroy would break his word with me, and should he, I could then appeal with confidence to the instructions of your excellency. I must here render full justice to the loyalty of the Chintai. In two

days he had erected a circular enclosure, formed of trunks of palm trees and sand-bags, which I visited in company with the generals. I did not see exactly 100 men in the fort, but concluded to shut my eyes to this deficiency. As a compensation, doubtless, there were three guns instead of only two as promised. Over it the Chinese flag waves. We were about coming to the conclusion. The Chintai had handed me a spy-glass and nautical instruments belonging to the Rover. I had the body of Mrs. Hunt. Mr. Pickering, reimbursed of his expenses, (say $100,) had left to bear to Tooke-took a red flag I had sent him. I had only to consign to a regular writing with the Chinese authorities the results of the expedition, (enclosures 5 and 6.) I beg to call the attention of your excellency to these documents, especially to the latter, which establishes a joint responsibility in the humane duty between the savages and the Chinese from Liang-Kian bay to the fort of Tossu-Pond. It is the morale of the whole expedition. This brings us down to the 15th of October.

I then thought of returning. I did not then know to how many annoyances (not to say humiliations) I should be subjected during the closing part of my mission. The steamship Volunteer, from the time I left with the Chintai, had gone to Tackao-Latter. When I saw that we were really on our way to the south, I requested the mandarin commanding to proceed to Liang-Kian. The answer was that the viceroy had ordered the steamer to remain at Tackao. But on the 11th of October I received a despatch from the mandarin commanding, to the effect that he had waited long enough, and that I must fix the date of my return to Amoy. I did not answer this communication, but on the morning of the 16th I sent my interpreter to Tackao to say to the mandarin, that my mission to Formosa having come to a close, I wished him to proceed to Tan Kian and save me, after a hard trip of nearly two months, the fatigue of a long journey to Tackao; and I said that I would take upon myself all the responsibility. I remained several days at Tossu-Pond after the withdrawal of the Chinese troops. On the 20th the British gunboat Banterer arrived on her way to Amoy from the Bashees islands. I met the commanding officer and the British consul at Tackao on the beach. At their request I furnished them with the main points of my mission and its results. I refused their kind offer of a passage to Tackao, and returned to Liang-Kian. There I found Mr. Pickering just returned from a visit to Tooke-took, from whom we had received a most cordial reception. The Chinese had not been so fortunate; they had sent a deputation to him to secure for their countrymen the protection promised to foreigners. The chief answered that he had done nothing and would do nothing with the mandarins. The deputies insisted, stating that the chief was mainly desired to treat of matters of mutual importance. Said Tooke-took, "If it is simply to talk, I can send my daughters;" and at once he begged Mr. Pickering to escort them to Liang-Kian, begging him to see them safe back to their friends at Poliac. These two girls appeared without fear before the mandarins, refusing to kneel before them. They boldly said that their father had treated with the foreigners because he respected their courage. He had seen them fearlessly ascending the mountain under fire, (alluding to the bold charge under McKenzie.) They had met him on his own territory to treat of peace, and their intentions were clear. But it was different with the mandarins, and he desired to have nothing to do with them. Having delivered this message, they refused to say more, and returned to Poliac with Mr. Pickering. Trifling as it may seem, this circumstance, together with the intrigues of the interpreter, had a great deal to do with Chintai Lew's change of manner toward us. We had given him no cause whatever of irritation.

On the morning of the 21st we made our parting visit to the generals, which they returned the next day. On the afternoon we received a note from the interpreter, stating that he had failed to induce the mandarin to bring the Volunteer to Liang-Kian, and we must be at Taikao on the 25th, the day fixed for his departure. We could not well leave the same evening by land, the Chintai

having but two chairs for us. We concluded to go by sea in a junk offered us by the Chintai. The wind was fair, yet we made no progress, as we kept continually tacking about, and in the morning we returned to Taulian. It was with great difficulty that we could get even two chairs, so that there was no conveyance for Mr. Pickering and our servants. Then, as we could not return with the army, we needed an escort. Mr. Bernard, who saw the Chintai Lew on this occasion, was instructed to accept without discussion any transportation that might be offered; but when he heard that the military escort was refused, he observed to the Chintai that I was suffering from an old wound in the eye, and could not but be troubled by these dispositions so different from my expectations. His answer was that he regretted it, but it was all he could do. Having directed Mr. Pickering to proceed on foot and detain the Volunteer till our arrival, I started with the generals the next day. We advanced rapidly, and at noon were at Tong-Kong, where we received no hospitality. At 3 p. m. we were at Chi-Tong-Kian, and could have reached Panglian the same evening. Suddenly our coolies halted, leaving us in the middle of the street, and disappeared. Having waited an hour, we were informed by one of our servants that the Chintai intended to stay there that night. I sent Mr. Bernard to him. The Chintai said the coolies were tired, and he could not force them to go on. In vain did Mr. Bernard observe that the coolies will go on if the Chinese authorities only permit them to do so. We were at their mercy.

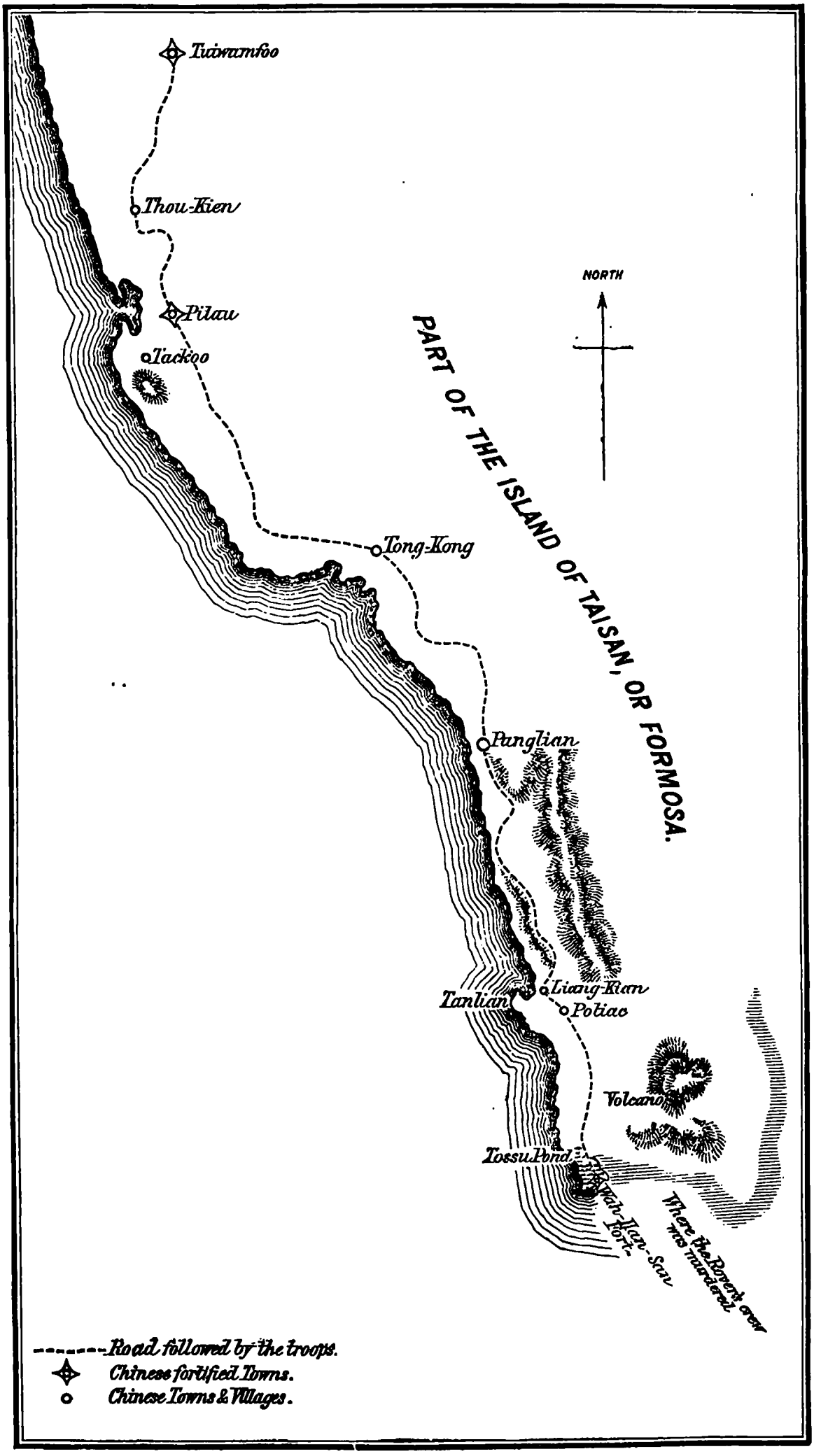
Fortunately we found a small junk loaded with wood. I hired it, paying partly in advance. But we had to wait an hour while she was unloading. While this was going on we noticed a mandarin in disguise ordering the owner of the junk not to take us. This man in this predicament hesitated, but having received from me the promise of protection, he concluded to take us on. The next day at 11 we were at Tong-Kong, and the wind having changed, we went ashore and made our way on foot to Tackao, where we arrived in the middle of the night.

On the 25th, as we had been notified, we were on board the steamship Volunteer. But now that we were on board the mandarin commander refused to leave, and I had to give him a peremptory order to start the next morning. I do not know whether the British consul at Tackao had anything to do with this. The fact is that during the day Mr. Carrol sent me a note, stating that he was expecting important despatches from Taiwanfoo, and had requested the Volunteer to be delayed one day, believing that I would have no objection. I called upon him to say that I was to my great regret compelled to leave at once. I regret to mention the name of this official in this communication, but you will notice that I found him at every stage of my negotiations with the Chinese in Formosa; once, six months before, when he wrote to the Taotai of Taiwanfoo that the Rover was a British vessel, and afterwards when in the proclamation of Ling-Kian the Rover was described as a British bark. Then when the mandarin delayed me in Tackao they told me that Mr. Carrol wished him to wait.

Having left at last with a favorable wind, suddenly, without a word of warning, we put back to Taiwanfoo. What could I say or do but submit? The next morning the wind had fallen. The sea was as calm as a lake; yet we remained at anchor. At length we set out; but only in a short time put in at the Pescadores. In short, having left Tackao on the morning of the 26th, we reached Amoy at 5 p. m. of the 30th. Two months before we had made the trip in 18 hours.

What am I to do in all this—Chinese intrigue—English jealousy? I do not know whether it is worth while to inquire. As for myself it all seems as nothing before the spectacle of our government, guided by the policy initiated by your excellency, compelling the Chinese authorities, through the force of persuasion alone, to do their duty in an unmistakable manner, and calling all civilized nations to partake of the benefits of these efforts.

Before closing this I beg to be allowed to mention the names of two gentle-


Taiwanfoo
Thou-Kien
Pilau
Tackoo
Tong-Kong
Panglian
Tanlian
Liang-Kian
Potiac
Volcano
Tossu Pond
Wah-Kan Fort
Scav
NORTH
PART OF THE ISLAND OF TAISAN, OR FORMOSA.
Road followed by the troops.
Chinese fortified Towns.
Chinese Towns & Villages.

men of good social standing who, without any possible hope of reward, have not hesitated to freely lend me their aid in the accomplishment of a mission which has proved laborious to me, while for them it has been full of danger and privation. They are Mr. Joseph Bernard, of Canton, (known by the French minister at Peking,) and Mr. Pickering, of Taiwanfoo. Mr. Pickering was by the side of Lieutenant McKenzie when shot by the aborigines on the 7th of June last.

I have the honor to be, sir, very truly, your obedient servant,

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

His Excellency ANSON BURLINGAME,
United States Minister at Peking.

UNITED STATES CONSULATE,
Amoy, November 19, 1867.

A true copy:

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

[Enclosure No. 1.]

The Viceroy to Consul LeGendre.

[Translation from the Chinese.]

25TH DAY, 7TH MOON, (*26th August,*) 1867.

First rank chief officer of the board of war and the viceroy of Fookien and Chiekien provinces to General LeGendre, consul:

When you came to Foo-Chow with a man-of-war you manifested your intention to go to Formosa, and expressed your willingness to change of steamer. Now the steamship Chang-Lin has arrived; you are at liberty to borrow her and use her as one of our friends.

Again, I give orders to the commander, Lew, to keep her clean and in good repair, and I have instructed him to treat you courteously, and have great care, when using the steamer, to make you comfortable.

Besides, I have written to him, and give this to you for your information.

WHO, *Viceroy.*

Deposition of Dr. Muller.

AMOY, *to wit:*

The information of Dr. Aug. Muller, physician and surgeon, of Amoy, taken and acknowledged on behalf of the people of the United States of America, touching the death of Mercy G. Bearnom Hunt, wife of Joseph Hunt, master of the American bark Rover, wrecked on or near the southern end of the island of Formosa, on or about the 14th day of March, in the year of our Lord 1867, and of the independence of the United States the 92d, before me, E. M. Smith, esquire, deputy consul of the United States at Amoy, United States deputy coroner for the port of Amoy, on an inquisition then and there taken, in view of some human remains, supposed to be part of those of the late Mercy G. (Bearnom) Hunt aforesaid, then and there lying.

This informant says: At the request of the United States deputy consul, I have come here at the American consulate to inspect what we suppose to be the remains of the late Mrs. Hunt, shipwrecked with her husband the late Captain Hunt, on or near the south cape of Formosa. I find part of skeleton consisting of—

1. A skull, minus the lower jaw.

2. Nearly the whole of a spinal column, partly in loose vertebræ, partly attached to each other, together with four ribs still joined to the latter.

3 All the bones of the pelvis detached from each other.

4. Part of a scrapula, (shoulder blade.)

From close inspection of the above I have come to the following conclusions:

1. These bones are undoubtedly *part of one female* skeleton, of more than average size according to European standard.

2. Judging from their appearance and condition they may well be the remains of the late Mrs. Hunt, taking into consideration the time elapsed since her supposed death, and the place where these remains are found. This opinion is further strengthened by the fact that a complete set of artificial teeth for the upper jaw, on an India-rubber base, with an artificial palate, belonging to the late Mrs. Hunt, which set is now produced in court, fits exactly to the upper jaw of the skull, making, of course, due allowance for the total absence of its fleshy parts. Further, the complete disappearance of the alveolar processes, with the exception of those of the last upper molar teeth of each side, corresponds with what one would require such a set of artificial teeth as are now produced in court as the property of the late Mrs. Hunt.

Dr. AUG. MULLER,
L. S., &c., &c.

AMOY, *November* 12, 1867.

Sworn before me at the United States consulate at Amoy, this 12th day of November, 1867.

E. M. SMITH,
United States Deputy Consul.

UNITED STATES CONSULATE,
Amoy, —— 20, 1867.

A true copy:

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Deposition of Charles W. LeGendre.

AMOY, *to wit:*

The information of Charles W. LeGendre, consul of the United States of America, at Amoy, taken and acknowledged on behalf of the people of the United States of America touching the death of Mercy G. (Bearnom) Hunt, wife of Joseph Hunt, master of the American bark Rover, wrecked at or near the southern end of the island of Formosa, on or about the 14th day of March, in the year of our Lord 1867, and of the independence of the United States the 92d, before me, E. M. Smith, esq., deputy consul of the United States of America at Amoy, United States deputy coroner for the port of Amoy, on an inquisition then and there taken in view of some human remains supposed to be part of those of the late Mercy G. (Bearnom) Hunt aforesaid, and there lying.

This informant on his oath says: On the 3d of September, 1867, I left for the island of Formosa with the steamship Volunteer, in the viceroy of Foo Chou's service, with the view to recover the remains of Captain Hunt and of his wife Mercy G. (Bearnom) Hunt, and of her friends. On or about the 16th of September I met, at Pang-lian, Formosa, Messrs. Pickering and Horn. They were then returning from the southern bay, where they had gone for the purpose of recovering the remains of the lamented Captain Hunt and of his wife. Both told me that they had recovered the body of Mrs. Hunt, lying at the time in Pang-

lian. I agreed to take the remains back to Amoy. On the 26th of October Messrs. Pickering and Horn sent to me on board the steamship Volunteer a box said to contain the remains of Mrs. Hunt, which I promised to send to Swatow to her friends. I inquired from Messrs. Pickering and Horn when, where and how they recovered the remains of Mrs. Hunt. They said the remains of Mrs. Hunt had been recovered from the Lingman tribe by a Chinaman living in this vicinity. He received the following information touching Captain and Mrs. Hunt's death. While the captain and their party were drying their effects Mrs. Hunt saw a Lingman woman on the beach; Mrs. Hunt asked her by signs to guide her husband and herself to Lian-Kian and offered her money; the woman was a Koolut, married to a Lingman. Instead of procuring guides the woman went direct to the mountains, directing the Kooluts to plunder and murder the party. The Kooluts came, and if we believe the account of a certain Attowat, a Chinese, Mrs. Hunt was first struck with a spear, afterwards with a sword, and fell dead; but while in the act of cutting off her head, the savage discovered that she was a woman and he left the body; shortly after two savage women placed the body under a tree and covered it.

On the 10th of October I met Tooke-took, the chief of the 18 tribes, south of Lian-Kian bay. The Kooluts are one of these tribes; I asked him what could have led the Kooluts to murder Captain Hunt, his wife and friends. He replied that a long time ago white people had all but exterminated the Koolut tribe, leaving only three who survived to hand down to their posterity the desire for revenge. Having no ships to pursue foreigners, they had taken their revenge the best way they could. He said nothing else of circumstances connected with Captain and Mrs. Hunt's death. This is a portrait said to be that of Mrs. Hunt, the spy-glass of her husband, I am told, and his sextant; they were handed over to me by Chiu-tai-lew, who recovered them from the savages.

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Sworn before me, at the United States consulate at Amoy, this 12th day of November, 1867.

[SEAL.]

E. M. SMITH,
United States Deputy Consul.

UNITED STATES CONSULATE,
November 21, 1867.

A true copy:

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE.

Deposition of Mr. J. H. L. Butefuhr.

AMOY, *to wit:*

The information of J. H. L. Butefuhr, of Swatow, brother-in-law of the late Mrs. Hunt, taken and acknowledged on behalf of the people of the United States of America, touching the death of Mercy G. (Bearnom) Hunt, wife of Joseph Hunt, master of the American bark Rover, wrecked on or near the southern end of the island of Formosa, on or about the 12th day of March, in the year of our Lord 1867, and of the independence of the United States the 92d, before me, E. M. Smith, esq., deputy consul of the United States at Amoy, United States deputy coroner for the port of Amoy, on an inquisition then and there taken in view of some human remains supposed to be part of those of the late Mercy G. (Bearnom) Hunt, aforesaid then and there lying.

This informant on his oath says: My sister, Mercy G. (Bearnom) Hunt, was

rather a tall woman, about 38 years of age; she had no teeth in the upper jaw; she had this set of artificial teeth manufactured in Hoboken, Hudson county, N. J., by Dr. Pruden, for the upper jaw, and an India-rubber base with an artificial palate made. I have the set with me; if it fits exactly the upper jaw of the skull I would believe that the remains now lying here, to the best of my knowledge and belief, are those of Mrs. Hunt; the roots of the upper molar teeth had never been extracted. The portrait recovered by General LeGendre is that of Mrs. Hunt. The spy-glass with sextant are those that Captain Hunt had with him when he left Swatow.

J. H. L. BUTEFUHR.

Sworn before me, at the United States consulate at Amoy, the 12th day of November, 1867.

[SEAL.]

E. M. SMITH,
United States Deputy Consul.

UNITED STATES CONSULATE,
Amoy, November 21, 1867.

A true copy:

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

Verdict.

AMOY, *to wit:*

An inquisition indented, taken for the people of the United States, at the United States consulate in the port of Amoy, in the empire of China, on the 12th day of November, A. D. 1867, and of the independence of the United States the 92d, before E. M. Smith, esq., deputy coroner of the people of the United States for the said port of Amoy, on view of some human remains supposed to be those of the late Mercy G. (Bearnom) Hunt, wife of Captain Joseph Hunt, master of the American bark Rover, wrecked on or near the southern end of the island of Formosa, on or about the 13th day of March, 1867, then and there lying, upon the oath of Charles W. LeGendre, United States consul, a naturalized American of the city, county and State of New York, Augustus Muller, a Prussian subject, M. D., and J. H. L. Butefuhr, of the city of Hoboken, Hudson county, in the State of New Jersey, good and lawful residents of, or for the time being visiting, the said port, duly chosen, and who being then and there duly sworn and charged to inquire for the people of the United States, when, how and by what means the said Mercy G. (Bearnom) Hunt came to her death, do upon their oaths say that: We consider that the evidence showed that the remains before us are those of Mrs. Hunt, (Mercy G. Bearnom,) late wife of Captain Joseph Hunt. That she came to her death by the hands of the aborigines of the Koolut tribe of the southern part of the island of Formosa, on the 14th day of March, 1867, and of the independence of the United States the 92d.

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE, *U. S. C., Foreman.*
J. H. L. BUTEFUHR, *Juror.*
DR. AUGUSTUS MULLER, *Juror.*

[SEAL.]

E. M. SMITH, *U. S. Deputy Consul at Amoy, and U. S. Deputy Coroner for the port of Amoy.*

UNITED STATES CONSULATE,
Amoy, November 21, 1867.

A true copy:

CHARLES W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

[Special.]

The United States consul for Amoy and dependencies to Chintai Lew, Chintai Chin and Sub-prefect Wang.

[A translation from the Chinese.]

CONSULATE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,
LIANG-KIAN, ISLAND OF FORMOSA,
October 15, 1867.

SIRS: The American bark Rover having been lost near the Koolut, her crew was murdered by the savages.

With two Chinese generals I came to Liang-Kian to recover the remains of the crew, and to punish the savages for their crimes. Afterwards we found that Mr. Pickering, an Englishman, my agent in Formosa, had succeeded in recovering the remains of Mrs. Hunt and her portrait, and he informed me that the bodies of the captain and crew had been destroyed previous to our coming.

Firmly believing from the reports that the savages are repentant and anxious to be pardoned, I have sent to you a few days ago a despatch with an agreement in eight articles. Your answer was that some of the articles had to be referred to Peking. You also notified me that my scheme could not be admitted to discussion, before I had met Tooke-took, and ascertained from him whether he was willing to come to terms. You also returned my despatch with your observations appended to each article.

On the 13th day of the present moon I, with my interpreter, the chiefs of the Canton and Tookien villages, met Tooke-took in the mountains, near the volcano, and received his offers to have the affair settled amicably. The chief promised that hereafter any shipwrecked crew, irrespective of country, should be taken care of by his tribes, and conducted to the nearest Chinese village, so that they may be taken to the head man of the Fookien settlement at Liang-Kian, and from there to Taiwanfoo, to be after turned over to their respective consuls on the main land (China.)

If you have found anything of the Rover I will thank you to turn it over to me. If hereafter any foreigner is murdered or molested by the savages, I should require from the Canton and Fookien settlements to promise, under bond, that they either will punish the savages by putting to death one savage for every foreigner beheaded, or deliver the murderer to the Chinese authorities. I should also require that the just expenditures of Mr. Pickering in recovering the body of Mrs. Hunt be refunded to him. If the aforesaid is done I shall be satisfied, and I am willing to enter into negotiations for the adjustment of the Rover's case on a peaceful footing.

I consider that the wild state in which the Kooluts live has kept them in ignorance of the treaties existing between foreign powers and China; and that they can be pardoned for their past crime, if they really intend to observe the treaty hereafter. If such is the case no advantage would be obtained in punishing them now.

I understand that General Lew has taken his troops to Tossu-Pond, where he has established a fortified camp, and that he is about to commence operations against the southern tribes. I am anxious to avoid bloodshed, and since I have received satisfactory assurances from Tooke-took, I write you this to request the withdrawal of the troops under your command. In case you would withdraw your troops, I would require that, agreeably with our verbal understanding of last night, you would not destroy the fortified camp of Tossu-Pond. I would ask also that on your return you promptly write to the viceroy, and ask him for his orders on the subject. I think that such a settlement would satisfy all concerned, and I shall be happy to co-operate with you in carrying it into execution.

On my return to Amoy I will immediately write to the viceroy and beg him to send you definitive orders on the subject of the fort.

CHAS. W. LE GENDRE,
United States Consul.

[A translation from the Chinese.]

Chintai Lew, Chintai Chin, Sub-Prefect Wang to General LeGendre, United States consul for Amoy and dependencies.

OCTOBER 18, 1867.

The savages having murdered the crew of the American bark Rover, we received orders from the high authorities to do our utmost to punish them. Therefore, we brought an armed force here. On the 15th day of this moon we moved our camp to Tossa-Pond, where we are now ready for offensive operations.

On the other side you have met the sub-chief of 18 tribes, and their ruler, Tooke-took, with a view of negotiating a satisfactory settlement of the present difficulties; all have said they would abstain from any hostile acts against foreigners, from all nations, cast on their shores by the elements. In consideration of this, and yielding to your humane feelings, you requested us to withdraw our troops and abstain from further repulsive demonstration. We also believe that God has created the savages; and if they are repentant, and determined to follow a better course hereafter, they will find us kindly disposed. Consequently I shall satisfy you and will withdraw our men. We shall not destroy the fort built at Mah-han-san, and we will leave in it two guns and a few tents. When you go to Foochow, request, if you please, the high authorities to communicate to us on the subject, and we will haste to obey their orders. The settlement of this affair rests on ten points; we submit them herewith to you as we have submitted them to the high authorities.

1. When you met the savage chiefs you asked them why they had murdered foreigners. Tooke-took said that in former times the foreigners killed all the Koolut tribe but two; that the survivors had made a vow, renewed by every succeeding generation, to behead as many foreigners as they had lost of their own fellows. Afterwards both of you exchanged words of peace, and you have agreed upon a flag of peace to be shown to all foreign consuls. The savages have promised to protect those who being the victims of the elements would land on their shore, that flag in their hands. Thus will cease all disputes or slaughter between both parties.

2. Mr. Pickering has found the upper part of Mrs. Hunt's body (bones) and her portrait at an expense of $100. This should be refunded to him. It shall be done as soon as we have received this sum from the savages. Again you ask that anything left from the Rover be turned over to you, and that you will give receipt for the same to be filed in our archives. We shall do so.

3. You mention a fort. The law requires to destroy all fortifications evacuated by troops on their way home, yet, considering the promise made to you, we will allow to remain the fortifications now standing, and leave in them a detachment of Tossa-Pond militia and a few soldiers for the service of the guns placed therein, to show our power, and until you have seen the viceroy and governor, and we will wait for their instructions on the subject.

4. You know well that we were ready to commence hostilities, and have abstained from it by deference to your wishes and the friendly agreement with Tooke-took. Therefore, we shall issue proclamation to all Fookien and Canton men and savages to obey our laws and commands.

5. As to the bodies of the Rover's crew, upon inquiries made both by Mr.

Pickering and by ourselves, we find that, in fear of us, the savages have thrown them into the sea.

6. From this date law exists, and if any men are killed the Canton and Fookien villages have given bond to apprehend the murderers and punish them.

7. You request us to appoint a civil mandarin at Liang-Kian. This is a measure of great bearing, and we have to refer you to the governor and viceroy and wait for their instructions.

8. Any foreign crew wrecked on the savage shore shall be protected by the savages, and we agree to rescue them and send them to the main land.

9. Now that peace exists I will thank you to notify the consuls and foreign powers that they should avoid to send their crews on shore unnecessarily, otherwise new difficulties may be raised. Should they require water or ballast they should show their flag in sign of friendship.

10. Being now at peace we have required the Fookien and Canton men to sign a bond, copy of which we send you herewith to be filed in your records.

CHINTAI LEW,
CHINTAI CHIN,
SUB-PREFECT WANG.

[A translation from the Chinese.]

THE BOND.

This agreement being a guarantee furnished by the head men of the Canton and Fookien villages, Sin-ah-kew, Chang-sin, Ugh-cheon-who, and the head men of the four Chenny-ke villages of half-cast, Su-quai-Sin.

We give this bond before the great men and gentlemen. We stand security for the savages and Kooluts. They unfortunately killed the crew of the Rover. Now the great troops have come to punish them and they repent. Again the ruler of the eighteen villages, Tooke-took, and the American consul having met together, have come to a friendly understanding. They have both agreed upon a flag to be a sign of peace. From this time any ship from any nation in danger of the elements that will show this flag will be succored by the savages. None of their crews shall be murdered; but all will be sent to our head men, and from there to Taiwanfoo.

We stand security before the court for the eighteen savage tribes, to this end that hereafter no foreigner shall ever be murdered. Should such crime be committed we all will unite with one heart and body with the soldiers to seize the guilty parties and punish them. And of so doing none of us will ever dare to refuse.

If foreigners land without necessity, and are murdered, we shall not be responsible.

We give this bond before the court, 9th moon, 6th year.

[Signatures]

NAVY DEPARTMENT,
February 10, 1868.

SIR: I have the honor to acknowledge your reference to this department of a copy of a resolution of the Senate, passed on the 5th instant, requesting the President to "communicate to the Senate, if compatible with the public interest, a copy of any official correspondence upon the subject of the murder, by inhabitants of Formosa, of the ship's company of the American bark Rover, wrecked upon the

coast of that island; and, also, relative to any measures which may have been adopted for the purpose of obtaining redress for the outrage;" and to transmit herewith copies of all correspondence on the files of this department bearing upon the subject of the resolution.

Very respectfully, &c.,

GIDEON WELLES,
Secretary of the Navy.

The PRESIDENT *of the United States.*

No. 39.] UNITED STATES FLAG-SHIP HARTFORD, (2d rate,)
Yokohama, Japan, April 30, 1867.

SIR: * * * * * * *

Upon my arrival at Amoy on the 4th of April, Commander Broad, royal navy, commanding her Britannic Majesty's steamer Cormorant, informed me that when at Takao, island of Formosa, on the 22d of March, he heard that the American bark Rover, Captain Hunt, had been wrecked on the Vile-Rete rocks to the southward of Formosa; that her officers and crew had taken to their boats, and that Captain Hunt, his wife, the second mate, and three Chinamen, landing in the bay on the south end of Formosa, were all murdered except one sailor, a Chinaman, (the other boat having separated from the first boat in the night-time,) by the wild men who inhabit a part of the island. These barbarians are said to be of most primitive habits, wearing no clothing and occupying no habitations, but living in the mountains and thickets.

Commander Broad sent out messengers to the aboriginals, proposing to ransom the survivors of the crew of the Rover, should he find any, and two days afterward, accompanied by Mr. Adams, her Britannic Majesty's consul at Takao, proceeded in his vessel to the place of the murder. Upon his attempting to land, however, he was fired upon from the bushes with muskets and bows and arrows, having one man wounded, whereupon he returned to his vessel and shelled the bushes, and then returned to Amoy.

Upon receiving this information I immediately despatched orders, by mail steamer then passing up, to Commander Febriger, of the Ashuelot, then lying at Foo-Choo, to visit the scene of the outrage, and to endeavor to rescue any survivors, if, by chance, there should be any. I have not as yet received the report of Commander Febriger's movements in pursuance of this order. His station remains the same as before reported. The Hartford could not perform this service without being too late for more pressing interests in Japan.

* * * * * * * *

I have the honor to be, &c.,

H. H. BELL,
Rear-Admiral, Commanding U. S. Asiatic Squadron.

Hon. GIDEON WELLES,
Secretary of the Navy, Washington, D. C.

[Extract.]

No. 44.] UNITED STATES FLAG-SHIP HARTFORD, (2d rate,)
Nagasaki, Japan, May 31, 1867.

SIR: * * * * * * *

The Ashuelot, (3d rate,) Commander Febriger commanding, under date of April 26, reports from Amoy his return from a visit to the ports of Tamsin, Taiwan-foo, and Takao, Loang, Kiao bay, and the scene of the late murder of the

crew of the Rover; also the Pescadores islands. Since the above-named date no advices have been received from the Ashuelot. The Chinese authorities at Formosa stated positively to Commander Febriger that all the officers and crew of the Rover, except one Chinaman, were murdered by the aboriginals.

* * * * * * * *

I have the honor to be, very respectfully, your obedient servant,

H. H. BELL,

Rear-Admiral, Commanding U. S. Asiatic Squadron.

Hon. GIDEON WELLES,

Secretary of the Navy, Washington, D. C.

[Despatch No. 46.—Series 1867.]

U. S. FLAG-SHIP HARTFORD. (2d rate,)

At sea, latitude 31° 31′ *N., longitude* 123° 47′ *E., June* 3, 1867.

SIR: Referring to my monthly report of April 30, 1867, I informed the department that Commander Febriger, in the Ashuelot, was sent to Formosa to rescue the surviving officers and crew of the American bark Rover, that had been wrecked to the southward of that island.

I have now the honor to enclose the report of Commander Febiger, marked A, received May 25th, of his proceedings, and the result of his investigation, by which it will be seen that it is probable that every one except one Chinaman, belonging to the Rover, was murdered by the savages living on Formosa.

This island is divided between three different races of men. The Chinese possess Kehing in the north, Tamsin, Tai-Wan-Foo, Takan, Lian Kiang—in fact, all the west coast, to within ten miles of the south end of the island, in which direction they are gradually extending their settlements. On the east coast is Tau-o harbor, the best on the island, inhabited by Chinese of a common order and some half-breeds of aborigines and Chinese. From here to the south end of the island there are two or three small villages of the same description of inhabitants, only more wild and savage, wearing scarcely any clothing, and are quite as hostile to foreigners, when good opportunities occur, as their wilder brethren, these bearing the blame.

The coast is high and rugged.

The pure aborigines live in the mountains and in the retired valleys, extending down to the coast, as wild as brutes, and not in villages, nor in huts even. They are in communication with half-breeds, though not with Chinese, who dread them.

Many American and European vessels have disappeared off the south end of Formosa at various times, in hurricanes and not in hurricanes. It has been long surmised that some of their unfortunate crews (like that of the Rover) after having escaped to Formosa, cruelly perished by the hands of the wild natives and half-breeds infesting that part of the coast. This well authenticated treatment of the Rover's crew confirms that opinion, and as there is no government to deal with in this matter, I shall proceed at once with this ship, and one or two others, to the south end of Formosa, and land small-arms men to scour the thickets there and break up whatever nests the wretches may have there. The department will perceive the difficulty of a transient force landed from ships getting at a foe that live more like monkeys than men.

Feeling this uncertainty, and knowing that the Chinese officials in the west of the island are extending their authority over the island, I directed Commander Febriger to induce the Taotai and chief officials to take this affair in hand, and possess themselves of the fine bay in the south end, offering them assistance, and

in any event to go there himself; but those officers decline this offer, pretending that they will send an expedition of their own in due time.

I am satisfied that the barbarities of those savages cannot be permanently stopped until the government at Peking be induced, by the action of the American and other foreign ministers at that court, to occupy all the villages and bays on the east coast, and on the south, and thus drive the aborigines back to the interior of the island. They are a cruel pest to all mariners who may be so unfortunate as to be thrown upon their coast, and there is no known way of dealing with them as a community.

I have the honor to be, sir, very respectfully, your obedient servant,

H. H. BELL

Rear-Admiral, Commanding U. S. Asiatic Squadron.

Hon. GIDEON WELLES,

Secretary of the Navy, Washington, D. C.

A.

UNITED STATES STEAMER ASHUELOT, (3d rate,)

Amoy, China, April 26, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor to report that, in obedience to your orders, dated the 5th instant, I left Foochow on the morning of the 11th, arriving at Tamsin the following morning, where I received your letter dated the 11th, directing me not to burn the cover at the place where the murder of the Rover's crew occurred, and expressing your desire that the Chinese authorities should take the initiative in the case.

Having visited and received return visits from the principal officials of Tamsin, we left on the 15th for Tai-Wan-Foo, anchoring off Makong harbor (Pescadores) and arriving off Tai-Wan-Foo the morning of the 18th.

I immediately forwarded a letter to the three principal authorities of the island, (General, Toatai and Prefect) informing them of the reported murder of the Rover's crew, and requesting that an immediate investigation of the case should be made, that in case there were any of the crew still surviving in the hands of the savages, immediate steps be taken to recover them; that a proper armed force be sent at once, so that all implicated in the murder might be seized and punished in accordance with Chinese law; also offering to assist and co-operate with my command in carrying out these objects. An answer to my letter was received the following day, stating that information of the case had been received previous to my arrival, that steps had been taken to investigate, and that an armed force should be sent to bring the perpetrators of the outrage to punishment. A copy of my letter to the authorities, and the original reply, with a rough translation, are enclosed herewith.

After the receipt of their letter I called upon the General, Taotai, and Prefect, individually, was well received by them all, and afterwards received return visits from them at a house provided for us by the Prefect.

During these interviews I expressed my anxiety as to the possibility of some of the crew of the Rover being still alive in the hands of the savages; their reply was that they had reliable information of their all having shared the same fate. To my request that an armed force should be immediately sent, and my assistance accepted, their reply was that the country was unknown to them; that proper persons had been sent to gain information, after the reception of which a force would be despatched immediately to make thorough work of it, and that my offered assistance would not be required.

The general in command appears to be an energetic, active man, and is of higher rank than the other authorities. He has, it is stated, about six thousand troops under his control, who are well armed and drilled. From his remarks

during our interview, I am of the opinion that he is desirous of making such thorough work in this case as to derive credit from the government at Pekin.

Leaving the anchorage off Tai-Wan-Foo on the 21st, we anchored the same afternoon off the port of Takow. Here I received a note from Mr. Carroll, the English consul, offering any information in his possession, and expressing a desire to accompany us. His note and a copy of my reply is enclosed.

There being no further information to be obtained here, we left on the 22d, anchoring the same day in Leang-Kaion bay. This place is only some ten or twelve miles distant from the scene of the murder, and I entertained hopes of receiving further and reliable intelligence, but was disappointed. I visited the village and had communication with the head man, who could not, or would not, give any information other than we already possessed. All my endeavors to procure a messenger to the savages was met with the assertion that any one going would lose his life. The opinion was general that all the Rover's crew were killed. Still I offered rewards to any one who would rescue the survivors if any, or produce reliable intelligence as to their fate.

Leaving this bay early on the morning of the 24th, I arrived in a few hours at the place where the murder was committed. Here at the head of the bay we found a Chinese boat at anchor, loaded with wood, and with a crew of four men. Bringing these men on board they were interrogated singly, the result of which was that they were from Tai-Wan-Foo; had been there eight days, detained five of them by the fresh northeast wind that was then blowing; that they had not been on shore; that the wood was brought off to them on bamboo rafts; that they had made arrangements to receive it upon arrival with a man named Mooi, residing on the west coast; that the inhabitants of the few huts visible from the ship at the head of the bay were half-breeds; that the savages lived on the other side of the hills; did not know if they have a village; that Chinese boats often come here for wood; knew that the savages had killed some strangers, but not how many. I endeavored to get one of these men to go on shore and enter into communication with the half-breeds, in the hopes of procuring a messenger to the savages. Promises of rewards and threats were alike useless, they asserting that the half-breeds were as bad as the savages, and would certainly kill them if they went ashore.

The Rover's boat spoken of by Commander Broad of the Cormorant, as being on the beach, has disappeared. Upon our arrival, and during our stay, the savages occasionally made their appearance on the hills several miles distant. Near our anchorage (which was at the head of the bay) there were three or four small huts, the inhabitants of which occasionally appeared, and seemed to be the half-breeds spoken of, by their costume (which was partially Chinese.)

The hills and shores of the bays (there being several of them) are well wooded, with a thick undergrowth coming down close to the water. I consider it impossible to fire it, in its present green state, and with the fresh northeast wind blowing during our stay. By shelling the underbrush well, a landing could be effected without loss, but in my opinion a force of at least 150 or 200 men would be required to advance any distance beyond the crest of the hills.

I enclose a sketch (by Dr. Manson of Takou) of the bay in which the murder of the first boat's crew took place, which will give you an idea of the locality.

Getting underway on the evening of the 24th, we arrived here on the morning of the 26th.

General LeGendre, the consul of Amoy, accompanied me during the cruise, and communicated with the authorities in relation to the case of the Rover's crew.

Very respectfully, your obedient servant,

JNO. C. FEBIGER, *Commander.*

Rear-Admiral H. H. Bell,
Commanding Asiatic Squadron,
U. S. Flag-ship Hartford, Shanghai, China.

UNITED STATES STEAMER ASHUELOT, (3d rate,)
Off Tai-Wan-Foo, Formosa, April 17, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor to inform you that the American bark Rover, on the 12th of March, 1867, ran upon a rock on the southern coast of Formosa island, and was so much injured, that to save their lives the crew were forced to take to the boats. The captain, his wife, second mate, and three (3) seamen, went in one boat and landed inside the southwest point of the island, about fifty (50) miles to the southward of Takao, where they are reported to have been murdered, with the exception of one seaman, who escaped. The other boat, with the chief mate and seven (7) seamen, are supposed to have landed near the same place, and to have met the same fate. As soon as this intelligence was received by Rear-Admiral H. H. Bell, commanding the naval forces of the United States in the China seas, he directed me to communicate with you, and request that an immediate investigation should be made of the case, and if any of the crew of the Rover were still alive in the hands of the natives, that they be immediately recovered and delivered over into the hands of the American authorities; also, that all persons implicated in this outrage be seized and punished in accordance with your laws. Admiral H. H. Bell expects that upon the receipt of this communication you will immediately order a proper armed force to search and seize all implicated for punishment; should you desire assistance, I hereby proffer all that is in the power of my command.

The American consul of Amoy, (China,) General LeGendre, accompanies me, and will address you a communication on the subject.

Hoping for an immediate and favorable reply, I have the honor to be, very respectfully, your obedient servant,

JNO. C. FEBIGER,
Commander United States Navy.

Their Honors, TAOTAI, PREFECT AND GENERAL,
Of Tai-Wan-Foo, Formosa.

[Translation.]

15TH DAY, 3D MOON, 6TH YEAR OF TONG SIN.

We beg to reply to you:

On the 14th day of the 3d moon, we received your letter stating: [a copy of my letter addressed to the authorities of Tai-Wan-Foo.]

We are investigating this case, which is now on file.

The Taotai say, on the 18th day, 2d moon, 6th year, I have received a letter from Consul Carroll, stating:

I beg to inform you that on the 8th day of this moon an English vessel sailing on the Leang-Kion sea, near the Red-head island, struck on a rock, and the crew, fourteen (14) in number, took to their boats to save their lives; they went to the Leang-Kion bay, at a place known as "Kow-ai-cas-pis-me." At this point the savages like to kill, as one likes to eat—those fourteen men escaping from the tiger's mouth fell upon the sword. Thirteen men killed, one escaping went to a village called Bia-a-Kiang, on the San-Chia-Shiang road, where the chief man and inhabitants furnished him a passage in a cargo boat to my consulate in Takou. The souls of those thirteen men cry for vengeance. I have found that this man has told me the truth. I shall report this case to my superior, and wish you to give orders to your authorities to find out all the truths, and also to punish the guilty parties, according to your laws, in order to prevent any similar occurrence in the future.

With many thanks, &c. &c.,

15TH DAY, 2D MOON, (Name on the card.)

Rec'd 18th day of 2d moon.

On the receipt of this letter I ordered the chief magistrate of Foo-Choo-Ching to communicate without delay with the military officer of the district to make

an investigation and report to me. I also directed that officer to issue a proclamation warning Chinese or foreigners against carelessly going into the territory of the savages, there being danger of their losing their lives by doing so. This officer reported to me that on the 29th he placed himself in communication with the military officer of the district, (Col. Leino;) they both passed Takou, and had an interview with Consul Carroll and Commissioner of Customs White. Those gentlemen described the savages as living like animals, and as being incapable of holding any communication with civilized people; the place is thickly wooded, and the savages hide themselves in the trees, and are in a perfectly wild state; that it would be difficult to employ an armed force against them. After that, I received a letter from Consul Carroll, stating his gratitude, as a copy herein enclosed shows. (This letter refers to another matter.)

I beg to inform you that on the 23d day of this moon I received yours of the 20th. I understand all. I have a letter from the captain stating that when he grounded on the west coast, you sent a force to protect him. The vessel is now safe and has gone to Amoy. I write this to you to thank you for your kindness.

27TH DAY, 2D MOON, (Name on the card.)

Rec'd 2d day, 3d moon.

(This letter is no reference to a vessel that grounded to the northward of Tai-Wan-Foo.)

(The GENERAL, TAOTAI and PREFECT.)

You perceive that when the intelligence of the murder of the Rover's crew reached us, an order was immediately given, before you arrived, to have the matter investigated by our authorities. But those savages are like animals living in the mountains and woods, that it is difficult to employ an armed force against them. Upon this the English consul and other officers agree. Formosa savages live like monkeys in the rocks; their territory is not on our maps; they do not obey our laws.

We have issued a proclamation warning any one person taking any animals into their territory for sale. We have placed guard at every gate to protect people from their cruelty. When that vessel was wrecked, and the crew went into the country of the savages, it was a fatality, for no one could help them.

If it is in our power to find means to punish those men, we should not refuse to do so, in order to keep peace with foreign nations. There is no necessity for you to trouble yourselves to furnish help to us to manage this case—if any one of you should happen to be hurt we should feel uncomfortable.

Now we are going to give orders to the civil and military officers to send a body of troops to manage this case. You say you wish to help us with your man-of-war. We beg you not to do so, so we write you this reply and enclose Mr. Consul Carroll's letter.

Seals of General Taotai and Prefect, (officers,) Tai-Wan-Foo, Formosa.

H. B. M. CONSULATE, *Taiwan, April* 28, 1867.

SIR: I have been compelled to proceed to Tai-Wan-Foo on public business, but trust to find you here on my return, which will be on Tuesday or Wednesday.

I leave Mr. Watters in charge of the consulate; he will be happy to render you any assistance or information you may require.

I am very anxious to accompany you on your expedition against the savages in the south, and think that my presence might be useful to you, from the fact of my having been on the spot before.

I am, sir, yours faithfully,

CHAS. CARROLL.

The COMMANDER *of the United States Ship Ashuelot.*

UNITED STATES SHIP ASHUELOT,
Off Takou, Formosa, April 21, 1867.

SIR: Your note of yesterday, with its kind offer of assistance or information, was received upon my arrival. I regret that I have not the time at my disposal to remain until after your return, as I am desirous of personally expressing my obligations for the exertions you have already made in behalf of the unfortunate crew of the Rover.

The punishment of all implicated in the murder is for the present in the hands of the Chinese authorities, and my visit to the place will only be for the purpose of gaining information; were it otherwise, your kind offer to accompany us would be accepted with thanks, and would doubtless be of great value.

Very respectfully, your obedient servant,
JNO. C. FEBIGER, *Commander.*

H. B. M. Consul CHARLES CARROLL, Esq.,
Takou, Formosa.

Skirmish with the savages of Formosa, by Rear-Admiral H. H. Bell, in the Hartford and Wyoming.

UNITED STATES FLAG-SHIP HARTFORD, (2d rate,)
Shanghai, China, June 19, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor to report to the department that in accordance with my instructions, No. 46, current series, under date of 3d June last, I left Shanghai on the 7th instant, in the Hartford, accompanied by the Wyoming, Lieutenant Commander Carpenter commanding, for the south end of the island of Formosa, to destroy, if possible, the lurking-places of the band of savages inhabiting the southeast end or point of that island, and who murdered in March last the shipwrecked officers and crew of the American bark Rover. On the 10th of June, on the passage down, I directed Commander Belknap of the Hartford to have 40 sailors armed with Plymouth muskets and 40 with Sharp's rifles, and all the marines, with five howitzermen; and Lieutenant Commander Carpenter of the Wyoming to have 40 Sharp's rifles and her marines all properly officered ready to land, provided with 40 rounds of ammunition and four days' rations and water; in all 181 officers and privates. The service cannot show a better drilled body than these. I stopped on the 12th instant at Takao, on the island of Formosa, to obtain an interpreter, and Mr. Pickering, a Scotchman, who had seen much of the natives, volunteered his services; they were accepted, he declining pay. I also received as my guests Mr. Taylor, a merchant at that port, and her British Majesty's consul Charles Carroll, esq., who humanely sent out messengers to communicate with the savages, with offers of ransom for all the survivors, if any remained, of the unfortunate crew of the Rover, and afterward went himself in the British gunboat Cormorant, Commander George E. Broad, to the bay in question, and was fired upon, when attempting to land there. These gentlemen having expressed a desire to be of the expedition, next morning, June 13, at half past 8 o'clock, we anchored within a half mile of the shore, on the southeast side of the large open bay indenting the south end of Formosa, a somewhat dangerous exposure at this season of typhoons, though a perfectly safe and convenient anchorage during the northeast monsoon, from October until May. The landing of 181 officers, sailors, and marines, provided with four days' rations and water, was made at half past 9 o'clock, under the command of Commander G. E. Belknap of the Hartford, accompanied by Lieutenant Commander Alexander S. Mackenzie, fleet lieutenant,

a second in command, who earnestly sought to go on the expedition. Soon after we anchored, the savages, dressed in clouts and their bodies painted red, were seen, through our glasses, assembling in parties of ten or twelve on the cleared hills about two miles distant, their muskets glistening in the sun, indicating the kind of arms they carried; their movements were visible to us on board during the most of the day. As our men marched into the hills, the savages, knowing the paths, boldly decided to meet them, and, gliding through the high grass and from cover to cover, displayed a stratagem and courage equal to our North American Indian. Delivering their fire they retreated without being seen by our men, who, charging upon their covers, frequently fell into ambuscades. Our detachments pursued them, in this harassing manner, out of sight of the ships, until 2 o'clock p. m., when, having halted to rest, the savages took the opportunity to creep up and fire upon the party commanded by Lieutenant Commander Mackenzie, and that officer, placing himself at the head of the company commanded by Lieutenant Sands, daringly led a charge into the ambuscade that was laid for them, and fell, mortally wounded by a musket ball, and died while being carried to the rear. The navy could boast no braver spirit and no man of higher promise than Lieutenant Commander S. Mackenzie. He was distinguished for professional knowledge, aptitude and tact, and suavity of manners which inspired the confidence and affection of the men, while his impetuous courage impelled him along to seek the post of danger, where he was always seen in the advance, both a conspicuous mark and an example. Several officers and men having already experienced severe sun-strokes, and the command being generally exhausted and worn out by their efforts to get at the enemy during four hours' marching, Commander Belknap now thought it expedient to rejoin his picket on the beach, and, during this march of two or three miles, many of the men got into such a deplorable condition from the killing heat of the sun that the commander determined to return with them on board of the ship, which he reached about 4 p. m., after an exhausting march of six hours under the sun at 92°. That afternoon the fleet-surgeon reported the casualties of the day—1 killed, 14 sun-struck, 4 of them dangerously. No sailors, indeed no troops unaccustomed to bush life, ever displayed better spirit, but it was apparent that sailors are not adapted to that kind of warfare against a skilful enemy, and that they could be fitted for it only by a lengthened experience. These considerations, together with the prostrated condition of many of the men and officers from sun-stroke, and their inability to stand another such day, decided me not to land them again, particularly as they had already done all that was practicable for them, namely: burnt a number of native huts, and chased their warriors until they could chase them no longer, though at a grievous cost of life. Their coverts of green jungle and green grass, being fire-proof at this season, cannot be destroyed, as I had contemplated. I observed a bamboo hut on every clearing, and several buffaloes feeding in the distance, these indicating that the natives are not so wild and ignorant of human comforts as they have been represented. The only effectual remedy against the barbarous outrages on shipwrecked men by this tribe, who are not numerous, will be for the Chinese authorities on the island to occupy this bay with a settlement of their own, protected by a military force, which may be effected through the influence of our minister at Pekin. Having accomplished all that was possible, I got under way at 9 p. m., and returning to Takao on the 14th instant, there buried the remains of the brave Mackenzie, with the prescribed honors, in the garden of the British consulate; Mr. Carroll, the British consul, having kindly proffered his garden for the grave, there being no public burying-ground at Takao. The consular flags and those of four merchant ships were worn at half-mast, and all the foreigners present joined in the funeral procession. At 6.30 p. m. on the 14th instant weighed anchor, and arrived at Shanghai to-day, expecting to meet the gunboats coming out to this squadron. Please receive herewith the detailed report of Commander Belknap,

marked A, with the reports of commanding officers of companies of the occurrences of the 18th of June, marked respectively B, C, D, E; also the report of Fleet Surgeon Beale, marked F, as to casualties.

I am, sir, very respectfully, your obedient servant,

H. H. BELL,

Rear-Admiral, Commanding U. S. Asiatic Squadron.

Hon. GIDEON WELLES,

Secretary of the Navy, Washington, D. C.

A.

Commander Belknap's report.

UNITED STATES FLAG-SHIP HARTFORD, (2d rate,)

At sea, June 15, 1867.

SIR: In obedience to your instructions delivered on the 13th instant, concerning an attack upon the savage tribes living on the southern extremity of the island of Formosa, I proceeded immediately to carry them into execution, so far as the character of the country, the nature of its inhabitants, and the extreme heat of the climate would permit. On leaving this ship, on the morning of the date referred to, I directed Lieutenant Commander J. H. Read, with a company of musketeers, a squad of scouts armed with Sharp's rifles, commanded by Master N. M. Folger, and a portion of the Wyoming's detachment, under the command of Lieutenant G. D. B. Glidden, to land in one of the bays, about three-quarters of a mile to the eastward of the place at which I proposed landing, and, pushing forward through the jungle, to make for the hills bearing away to the westward, in order to flank the enemy and unite with the main body on the summit of the hill. I then pulled into the bay to the northward of the ship's anchorage, and effected a landing without opposition or difficulty, Lieutenant Commander A. S. Mackenzie of your staff being the first to jump on shore. The marines were immediately thrown out as skirmishers along the edge of the jungle which skirts the coast and reaches down to within a hundred yards of the beach, and after securing the boats and establishing a strong picket of seamen and marines, provided with a light howitzer to protect the flank, all under command of Gunner Cross of this ship, and Gunner Staples of the Wyoming, I moved on through the jungle toward the hills, to the right of the large black rock indicated in the accompanying plan.

This belt of jungle seems to be about a third of a mile in width, and the march through was very slow, circuitous, and toilsome. Now and then narrow foot-paths or trails would be entered, but they were soon lost in a thick undergrowth of prickly plants and runners, and low branches of a small species of banyan tree, and the men were obliged to force their way through as best they could.

As we emerged from the jungle we entered an open space of some ten acres in extent, with a few straggling huts and clumps of bushes scattered here and there over its surface. A little further on, the hills could be seen rising from the plain, broken into spurs with deep ravines between, filled with rocks and a thick growth of grass and small trees. Having examined the huts, they were fired, and the command pushed on up one of the hills to the right of the large rock marked in the plan. No enemy could be seen, except at a great distance on the crest of the hills about us and toward our right; but a scattering fire was suddenly opened upon us from an ambush just below the big rock. We fired a volley in return, and halting a few minutes under cover of some bushes, I divided the command, directing Lieutenant Commander Mackenzie to remain quiet with his portion of the party until I could make a flank movement to the right, when, at a signal given by the drum, he would move on up the hill and rejoin me. In the mean

time Lieutenant Commander Read had landed with his detachment, and could now be seen on the hills on our right at a distance of about two miles, and an occasional fire of musketry was seen to open on the party from the hills above.

Lieutenant Commander Mackenzie having rejoined us at the base of the big rock, we kept on slowly up the hill, bearing away toward the right, receiving now and then a fire from the bushes in all directions, some shots close, others from a great distance. Fortunately the enemy fired too high, and most of the bullets passed over us. At one point a volley was poured into us at a distance of not more than a hundred yards, and Lieutenant Commander Mackenzie and Lieutenant Sands, advancing with a party of scouts, supported by the main body, charged into the ambush, but the wily foe had fallen back with wonderful rapidity, and made known their escape by loud holloes from the thickets beyond.

Only occasional glimpses of the enemy could be caught, their presence being generally discovered by sudden shots from the bushes, and flashes of sun-light reflected from their bright-barrelled muskets. At nearly all the points from which we were fired upon I noticed small bundles of bamboo lashed to the bushes at a small angle, seemingly for protection to our cunning foe, and to serve as marks to guide them from one ambuscade to another. As we advanced, the open space on the hill-side became more confined, and rocks, bushes, dense jungle, and rugged ravines afforded increasing facility and shelter to the savages, and gave us no hope or chance of getting at them. About a mile or more above the big rock already mentioned, the men had become so much exhausted from the march, and the intense heat of the sun, that I ordered a halt, and entered a belt or jungle to give them a little shelter and rest. Lieutenant Commander Mackenzie and Lieutenant Sands, with a party of scouts, were posted in a small thicket above, and to the left of the main body, and a strong picket of marines occupied another clump about one hundred yards below the other party; these outposts, together with the position of the main body, making, as it were, the angles of a triangle.

Those pickets having been established, I sent for Lieutenant Commander Mackenzie, the second in command, to consult with him concerning a further advance. He had been with me about 20 minutes when firing was heard in the direction of the advance picket, and he hurried back to the front. Meanwhile Lieutenant Sands had returned the fire, and was charging toward the spot where the enemy lay concealed, when Lieutenant Commander Mackenzie coming up, ordered a halt. The moment the latter reached the head of the line he ordered a fresh advance, himself leading. During the interval the main body had come out of the jungle, and were pushing on to the support of the picket line, when I heard the cry, "A man wounded; send for the doctor." I called out for Doctor Page, who went to the front and soon after brought Lieutenant Commander Mackenzie, lying wounded in a blanket, near the spot where I was standing, and by my order carried him further back to the rear. The spot from which these shots came was backed by a deep ravine, and immediately to the rear the jungle came down on all sides, so that further advance in that quarter would have exposed the command to the risk of continued loss without any means or hope of retaliating upon the enemy. The men, too, were beginning to show great fatigue and symptoms of sun-stroke, and considering the difficulty of moving either way, cumbered with sick and wounded men, I determined to fall back. I accordingly ordered a retreat, sending the main body ahead, and falling back slowly, covered by the scouts under command of Lieutenant Sands. A short distance down the hill Lieutenant Commander Reed joined me with his party, and was directed to fall back with the main body, a party of carbineers under Mr. Folger remaining with Mr. Sands. Mr. Read had destroyed several huts on the route he had taken, but failed to accomplish any other object of the expedition. We were fired at from several places on the way down the hill, but happily no other shots took effect. Before we

reached the plain, word was sent me of the death of the gallant Mackenzie. Upon entering the jungle fringing the coast the different squads and companies took different routes to guard against ambush, and our progress was slow and fatiguing, particularly to the men who carried the remains of the lamented Mackenzie. Arrived at the beach I deployed the marines along the edge of the jungle to guard against surprise, and sent the body on board ship the moment the boat could be got ready. It had been my intention to remain on shore and attempt an ambuscade in the jungle during the night, but I found both officers and men so worn out from exertion and extreme heat of the day, that I concluded to embark the entire command and return to the ship.

Captain Forney, of the marines, and Mate Brownall, of the Wyoming, and a dozen or more of the men were already prostrated with sun-stroke, and I feared other cases might occur before nightfall. The route over which we passed was entirely destitute of cattle, fruit, vegetables, or any other eatable thing; and we had seen only two or three pools of dirty stagnant water, unfit for any one but a savage to drink. That part of Formosa is extremely well adapted to Indian modes of warfare, and the burning heat of the sun at this season of the year is a greater help to the savage even than either his cunning and cruel method of fighting, or perfect knowledge of every foot of ground over which he ranges.

The officers, one and all, gave me a hearty and efficient support, and the men did their duty cheerfully and steadily. The following are the names of the officers who went in the expedition, viz:

Lieutenant Commander A. S. Mackenzie of your staff, Lieutenant Commander J. H. Read, Lieutenant J. H. Sands, Master W. M. Folger, Master H. Elmer, Captain James Forney, United States marine corps, Assistant Surgeon C. H. Page, Gunner R. H. Cross, Admiral's Clerk Louis Parker, and Commander's Clerk A. C. Driggs of this ship, and Lieutenant G. D. B. Glidden, Mate G. V. Brownell, and Gunner J. L. Staples, of the Wyoming.

The British consul at Takao, Formosa, Charles Carroll, esq., and Messrs. Taylor and Pickering, English subjects residing at that place, accompanied the expedition as volunteers and rendered good service, being generally at the front. Mr. Taylor went to the assistance of Lieutenant Commander Mackenzie when the cry of "a man wounded!" was heard. The following named men deserve special mention for the faithful manner in which they remained by the body of the lamented dead and brought it safely through the jungle to the boats, viz: John Kelly, captain of forecastle; Robert Knight, armorer; James Franklin, boatswain's mate; William White, captain of foretop; James McGinnis, ship's corporal; James Cunningham, seaman; and John M. Small, ordinary seaman. One of them, William White, dropped down from exhaustion and sun stroke the moment he reached the beach. The gallant dead needs no tribute from me. That solitary grave in the grounds of the British consulate at Takao bespeaks a language more eloquent and touching than human utterance can express. No one knew the worth, the high-toned character, and professional ability of the deceased better than yourself, and I but give expression to the general feeling when I add that in him the service lost one of its brightest ornaments, and the country one of its most zealous and gallant defenders. I enclose a sketch of the routes taken by the expedition; also, reports from Lieutenant Commander J. H. Reed, Lieutenant Sands, Assistant Surgeon C. H. Page, and Captain Forney. I found the soundings from the ship to the shore to decrease regularly and gradually, and the beach quite steep, too; but large, flat black rocks could be seen on the bottom here and there, which would make a dangerous sea for boats in a southerly wind. I could discover no traces of human beings or remnants of clothing worn by civilized people in any of the huts we destroyed, or in any part of the country over which we passed. On our return through the jungle skirting the coast we struck into the bed of a dry stream, when nearly

through, which doubtless runs with good water during the northeast monsoon, which would be of great advantage to a force operating there during the winter months.

Very respectfully, your obedient servant,

GEORGE E. BELKNAP, *Commander.*

Rear-Admiral H. H. BELL,
Commanding United States Asiatic Squadron.

Report of Captain Forney.

UNITED STATES FLAG-SHIP HARTFORD,
At sea, June 17, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor herewith to submit a brief report of the part taken by the marines on the 13th instant on the island of Formosa. On first landing, by your order I took charge of 20 marines, deploying them forward as skirmishers. A dense and almost impenetrable thicket of brush prevented the men from advancing very rapidly. I penetrated with them to a creek about half a mile from the beach without meeting with any of the enemy, and was then recalled for further orders. You then instructed me to leave a sergeant and five men on the beach, and to advance with the main body headed by yourself. In consequence of all further operations coming under your own observations, I have nothing further to report, except that the men behaved gallantly, and deserve credit for the manner in which they marched over such a rough and hilly country and under such intense scorching heat. Ordnance Sergeant Goltermeyer was of great assistance to me during the entire day, and deserves favorable mention. A few of the men were struck down by the oppressive heat of the sun, but were not seriously injured and are now doing their usual duty. The entire number of marines on shore was 43, 31 of whom were from this ship, and 12 from the Wyoming. I have to report the loss of one Springfield rifle, (I think this rifle is on board of the Wyoming by mistake,) one fife, one musket sling, and two canteens.

Very respectfully, your obedient servant,

JAMES FORNEY,
Captain United States Marine Corps.

Commander G. E. BELKNAP,
Commanding U. S. Steamship Hartford.

Report of Lieutenant Commander Read.

UNITED STATES FLAG-SHIP HARTFORD, (2d rate,)
At sea, June 17, 1867.

SIR: In obedience to your order I have the honor to submit the following report of the movements of the men under my command at South Cape, island of Formosa, on June 13, 1867. The column consisted of the following detachments, viz: 22 men from the Wyoming, under command of Lieutenant Glidden; 62 men from the Hartford, under command of Master Horace Elmer, and a skirmish party of 10 picked men from the Hartford, under command of Master W. N. Folger; total 94 men, five of them being equipped as pioneers. On reaching the place designated by you for our landing, the boats were beached, and the skirmishers, under Master Folger, deployed to the front. The line of battle was quickly formed, and after mooring the boats 200 yards from the beach, we took up our line of march for the interior, striking for the high range of hills that lay about two miles from the shore line. The march was painful and tedious, owing to the dense jungles of cactus and rose-vines which covered the soil. But after a tramp of two hours we gained the hills, and

destroyed several small houses which had very lately been abandoned. Shortly afterwards several small parties of savages were seen on the hill-tops in our front, who fired at long range upon our skirmish line, but quickly retreated upon their fire being returned. In this manner they kept up a sort of running fight, retreating from one hill-top to another, never allowing our skirmishers to approach nearer than 800 yards, for about one hour. But this chasing over rugged hills, through almost impassable chaparral, and under a scorching tropical sun, soon told on our men, and after giving them a short rest, I turned the column to the left in order to join your command, in obedience to my original orders. The main body at this time was about one mile distant, and our march to join it was the most painful of any during the day—many of the men dropping down with sun-stroke, required to be helped along by their comrades. Upon coming up with you the commands were consolidated, and the rest of the movements took place under your eye, which makes it unnecessary for me to report further. I am happy to be able to say that all the officers and men behaved gallantly, the skirmish party, under Master W. N. Folger, having the hardest marching, and being the only ones that were annoyed by the savages.

Very respectfully, your obedient servant,

J. H. READ,
Lieutenant Commander.

Commander G. E. BELKNAP,
Commanding United States Steamer Hartford.

Report of Assistant Surgeon Page.

UNITED STATES FLAG-SHIP HARTFORD, (2d rate,)
At sea, June 15, 1867.

SIR: In accordance with your request, I have to report the circumstances attending the death of Lieutenant Commander A. S. Mackenzie of the United States steamer Hartford, during a skirmish with the natives of the southern extremity of the island of Formosa, upon the 13th of June, 1867. The main body of the troops, with which Lieutenant Commander Mackenzie was connected, landed at about 10 o'clock a m. and proceeded into the interior of the country about four miles, and had halted for rest and shade in the border of a dense jungle at about 2 o'clock p. m., with a detachment of 10 men, under the immediate command of Mr. Mackenzie, thrown out to one side to watch the movements of the enemy, who had been firing upon us. Soon after halting Mr. Mackenzie was called into the jungle by the officer in command for a consultation as to movements, and during the consultation, the enemy recommenced firing. Mr. Mackenzie rushed to the head of his men, and in about two minutes I heard the cry of "Doctor! doctor!" and immediately proceeded to the front, where I found Mr. Mackenzie falling, with his left hand on his right breast. I caught him by the coat-collar, and asked him where he was wounded, at the same time with what aid I could procure dragged him to the rear as rapidly as possible. In reply he only looked up at me, moved his hand on his breast a little higher, and said "Page, Page, Page, I'm dead!" and ceased to live at about 2.30 p. m., and about three or four minutes from the time that he was wounded. The wound was round, smooth, of about an inch in diameter, penetrating deeply the upper anterior and middle portion of the right chest just below the collar-bone, with no external hemorrhage of importance.

Very respectfully, your obedient servant,

CHARLES H. PAGE,
Assistant Surgeon.

Commander GEORGE E. BELKNAP,
U. S. Navy, Commanding U. S. Steamer Hartford.

Report of Lieutenant Sands.

UNITED STATES STEAMER HARTFORD,
At sea, June 15, 1867.

SIR: The following is a memorandum of the circumstances attending the death of Lieutenant Commander A. S. Mackenzie, as far as I am able to state: At about 2 o'clock p. m., on the 12th instant, Mr. Mackenzie called for volunteers from the Hartford, and I joined him with the 10 or 12 men then under my command, in answer to his call. We were stationed behind a clump of bushes to keep a lookout for the enemy. A few minutes after we had taken our position Mr. Mackenzie was sent for by you and I was left in charge of the party. At about 2½ p. m. we were fired on by the enemy, who had got on our flank through the undergrowth, and I ordered a change and returned their fire. As soon as the firing commenced Mr. Mackenzie ran up to head the party, and ordered a halt before we had advanced more than 30 yards. As soon as he had reached the front he ordered an advance, and was leading the attack when we were fired on by another party at a distance of about 75 yards. The enemy fired five or six shots at once, and it was one of those that struck Mr. Mackenzie. I did not know that he was seriously hurt, and left him walking to the rear to meet the doctor, who was coming up at the time. We fired two or three volleys at the enemy and drove them back, but before we had advanced more than fifteen yards further I received the order to fall back, and it was not until ten minutes after that I learned that Mr. Mackenzie was mortally wounded. To reach the enemy we charged across a gully filled with long grass, which impeded our movements, and ahead of us still there was a ravine backed by dense undergrowth. It was impossible to tell the position of the enemy until we saw the smoke of his pieces, and we were obliged to fire at the flash. We were in plain sight, an open mark for the enemy, while they were hid in this undergrowth, into which we could not see ten feet.

Very respectfully,

J. H. SANDS, *Lieutenant.*

Lieutenant Commander BELKNAP,
United States Steamer Hartford.

Report of the Fleet Surgeon.

UNITED STATES FLAG-SHIP HARTFORD, (2d rate,)
South Bay of Formosa, June 13, 1867.

SIR: I have the honor to report that the following casualties occurred among the officers and men of this ship to-day, on shore, in the affair with the savages of this part of the island, viz:

A. S. Mackenzie, lieutenant commander, killed.
George E. Belknap, commander, sun-struck, severely.
James Forney, captain marines, sun-struck, severely.
William White, captain fore-top, sun-struck, dangerously.
William Jackson, ordinary seaman, sun-struck, dangerously.
Joseph Quinton, seaman, sun-struck, dangerously.
Philip Worrishoffer, sun-struck, dangerously.
John H. Earle, ordinary seaman, sun-struck, slightly.
Edward Forrest, landsman, sun-struck, slightly.
Martin Finnerty, ordinary seaman, sun-struck, slightly.
Eugene Sullivan, ordinary seaman, sun-struck, slightly.
Thomas Savage, landsman, sun-struck, slightly.

George K. Mills, landsman, sun-struck, slightly.
John Hynes, ordinary seaman, sun-struck, slightly.
William Connor, marine, contusion.

Numerous other cases of exhaustion from heat and over-fatigue presented themselves on the return of the expedition to the ship, but as they went to duty almost immediately, I have not thought proper to include them in the above list. I will remark, however, that the men generally, when they came back to the ship, presented a most exhausted and broken-down appearance.

Very respectfully, your obedient servant,

J. BEALE, *Surgeon of the Fleet.*

Rear-Admiral H. H. BELL,
Commanding United States Asiatic Squadron.

P. S.—I would also state that Mate Brownell, of the Wyoming, was also brought on board this ship in a state of delirium, following heat and exhaustion, but that he recovered sufficiently in the course of a couple of hours to be sent to his own ship.